STUDY COMPANION · SAT-002-C

Lighting the Inner Lamp

The Light of Diwali Within

Diwali Satsang, New Lynn

Sunday 8 November 2026, 11:00 am to 1:00 pm

Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre, 27 Arawa Street, New Lynn, and on Zoom

Swami Tadananda

Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre, Auckland · mail@vedanta.nz

Companion to the 30 slides, SAT-002-S. Version 1.0, 2 November 2026.

Contents

	Introduction: how to use this companion	4
1	Lighting the Inner Lamp	5
2	Our morning, and one minute of silence	6
3	Two ways to keep Diwali	7
4	Song: Ke jane Kali kemon (Bengali and meaning)	8
5	Song: Ke jane Kali kemon (continued)	9
6	What the song says	10
7	The verse of the inner light	11
8	Sri Krishna's lamp of knowledge: Gita 10.10 and 10.11	13
9	The Sun of Knowledge, and the lamp	15
10	The mind as mirror and cloth	16
11	Chitta-shuddhi in the Gita (5.11 and 16.1)	17
12	Clearing the mirror, in our course's words	19
13	Sattva in the Gita (14.6 and 14.11)	20
14	The three rise and fall (14.10, 14.17, 14.18)	22
15	What sattva looks like: the divine qualities (16.1 to 3)	24
16	The six marks we will use today (12.13)	26
17	Sattva in daily life: food, conduct, speech (17.8, 17.14, 17.15)	27
18	Sattva in daily life: mind and giving, knowing (17.16, 17.20, 18.20)	29
19	Sattva in daily life: acting, the doer, the happiness (18.23, 18.26, 18.37)	31
20	The Ramayana of the body	33
21	Seven doors for the inner lamp	34
22	Purity in everyday dealings	35
23	Two wings: meditation inwards, worship outwards	37
24	How do we know we are growing?	38
25	Looking back, gently: the year behind	39
26	Looking ahead, lightly: the year ahead	40
27	Diwali at home tonight	41
28	Guided meditation: the lamp in the heart	42
29	Closing song: Hey Sharde Maa (stanza 1)	43
30	Closing song: Hey Sharde Maa (stanzas 2 and 3)	44
A1	The Lamp card	46
A2	The evening at home and the guided meditation	46

A3	Songs, sources and how we quote	3
A4	Questions to keep, and the Zoom and next satsang details	47

Introduction: how to use this companion

This companion goes with the 30 slides of the Diwali satsang **Lighting the Inner Lamp**. It is written so that a person who was not present, or who joined online and wants to go slowly, can follow the whole morning alone.

THE ONE THREAD

Which lamp am I lighting this Diwali, and what stands between that lamp and its light? The satsang moves through six parts: the festival, the question and the opening song (slides 1 to 6); the light we celebrate (slides 7 to 9); why the light is not always seen, the mind as mirror (slides 10 to 12); sattva, what a clear mind is, in the Gita's words (slides 13 to 19); the Ramayana of the body, and grace and practice (slides 20 to 23); and how we know we are growing, the year behind and ahead, the evening at home, the sitting and the closing song (slides 24 to 30).

HOW EACH SLIDE IS TREATED

- **On the slide**: what the slide says, in plain prose.
- **Verses**: Devanagari, roman transliteration and English, with the reference.
- **Word by word and key terms**: the Sanskrit and other terms to know.
- **Commentary**: explanation in plain words, in short headed paragraphs.
- **Going deeper**: where the quotation comes from, and context.
- **Reflect**: the Pause and discuss question for the slide.

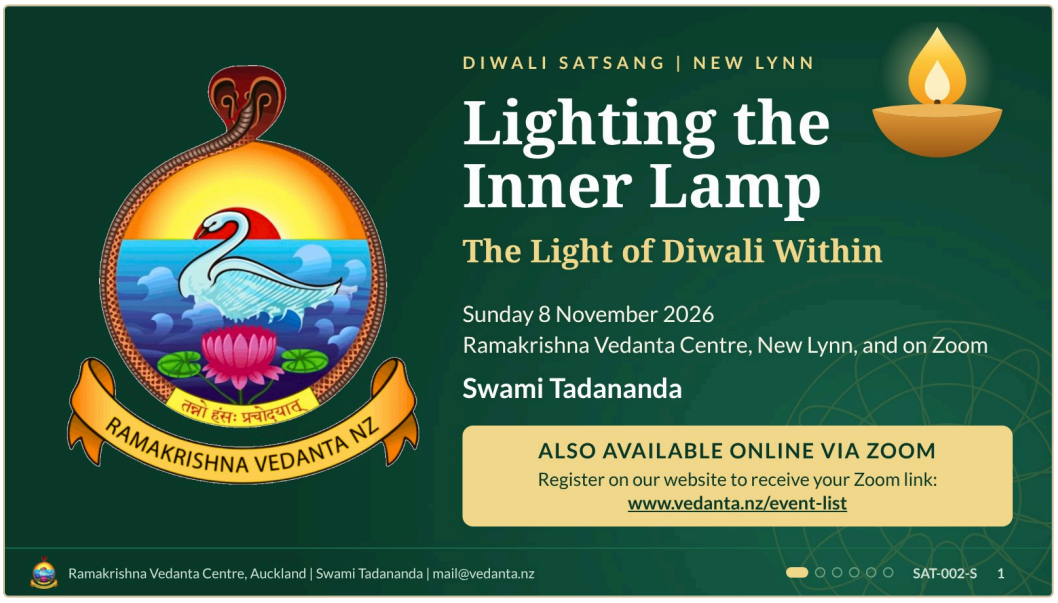
A SUGGESTED WAY TO STUDY

Read the slide first, then the commentary, then answer the reflection question in writing, one or two lines. If you are studying alone, take the question first and write before you read the notes; you will be surprised what you already know. Take one or two slides a day. After the last slide, take the 25-question quiz on the web page for this satsang, and fill in the Lamp card (Appendix A1).

WHAT IS A QUOTATION AND WHAT IS OURS

Quotations come from the Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, the Gospel of Holy Mother, the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda, and the Bhagavad Gita as given in Swami Tadananda's Gita Study for Sunday Classes. The verse of the inner light (slide 7), the lines of the songs, and the quotation from Swami Ranganathananda (slide 24) come from other sources and are labelled. The English of Gita 17.8 to 18.37 on slides 17 to 19 is our paraphrase and is marked so. Where we give our own reading, we say so.

SLIDE 1 Lighting the Inner Lamp



ON THE SLIDE

This is the New Lynn Diwali satsang on Sunday 8 November 2026. The title names one idea for the whole morning: Diwali has an outer lamp and an inner lamp, and the festival is most itself when the first reminds us of the second.

The band at the foot of the slide is for people joining by Zoom. Registration is on the Centre's website, and the same slides are shown to both rooms.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Dīpāvalī / दीपावली	'the row of lamps', the festival of lights
Antarjyoti / अन्तर्ज्योतिः	the light within

COMMENTARY

WHAT THIS MORNING IS FOR

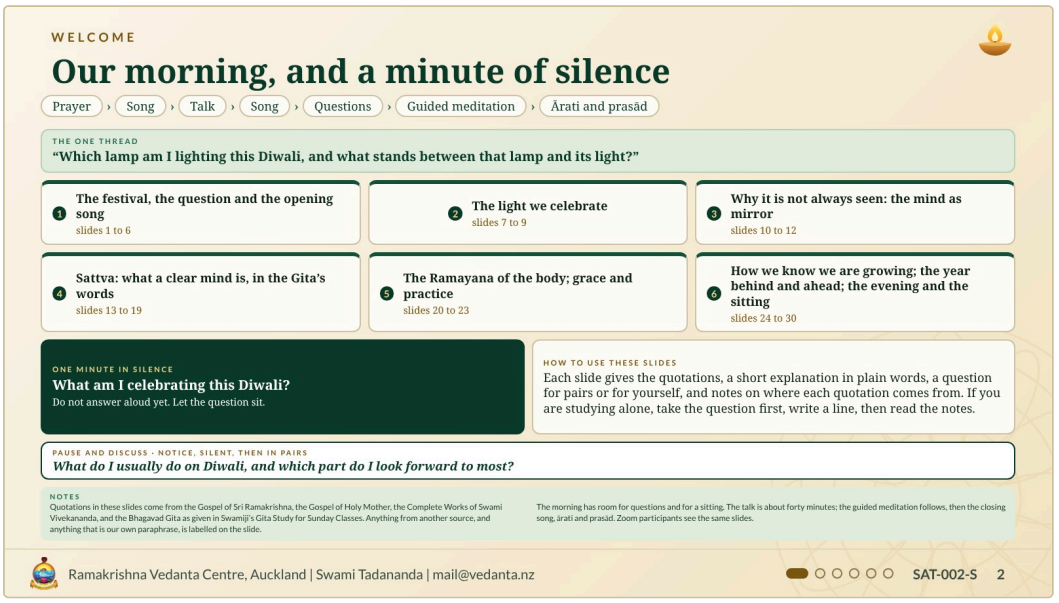
Most of us know how to keep the outer festival: lamps at the door, sweets, family, and perhaps a visit to the shrine. This satsang asks what is left when the lamps are put away. The answer we explore is that the light was never in the lamp. The lamp is a pointer, and what it points to is the clarity of our own mind, through which the light of the Self shines.

The talk is built as one thread. It begins with a song to the Divine Mother, then asks where the light is (the Gita and Sri Ramakrishna), why we do not always see it (the mind as a mirror), what a clear mind looks like (sattva, in the Gita's own words), and what we can do about it (seven doors, seva, and a few honest questions). It ends in practice: a Lamp card to fill in, a short evening rite for home, a guided meditation and a closing song.

HOW TO STUDY THESE SLIDES ALONE

Read the slide first, then the explanation here, then answer the question for yourself in writing. If you were present on the day, use the notes to revisit the parts that went quickly. If you joined online, the numbered slides and this companion carry everything that was shown.

SLIDE 2 Our morning, and one minute of silence



ON THE SLIDE

The morning follows a simple order: prayer, song, talk, song, questions, guided meditation, then ārati and prasād. The slide lists the six parts of the talk with the slide numbers, so a reader can find any part.

A single question holds the morning together: "Which lamp am I lighting this Diwali, and what stands between that lamp and its light?" The slide then asks for one minute of silence on the question "What am I celebrating this Diwali?" with no answer aloud.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Ārati / आरती	the waving of lights before the deity at the close of worship
Prasād / प्रसाद	food offered to the Divine and shared, received as grace

COMMENTARY

WHY BEGIN WITH SILENCE

A question asked in silence is heard differently from one answered at once. The minute is not a test. Its purpose is to let the first honest answer rise before the mind tidies it. Many people find the first answer is simple: family, light, a feeling of gladness, or a duty. All of these are good starting places.

THE ONE THREAD

The question has two halves. 'Which lamp?' asks us to notice whether our Diwali is outer, inner or both. 'What stands between that lamp and its light?' is the harder half: it assumes the light is there and asks what blocks it. The rest of the satsang is an answer to the second half.

HOW THE SLIDES ARE ARRANGED

Each teaching slide has four parts: the quotation, a short explanation in plain words, a Pause and discuss question, and a notes strip saying where each quotation comes from. Anything that is our own paraphrase or reading is labelled as such, so a reader can always tell a scripture's words from ours.

GOING DEEPER

ON QUOTATIONS AND SOURCES

Quotations in this satsang come from three books of the Centre: the Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, the Gospel of Holy Mother and the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda, together with the Bhagavad Gita as given in

Swami Tadananda's Gita Study. The verse of the inner light and the Ranganathananda quotation come from outside these books and are labelled on their slides.

REFLECT

What do I usually do on Diwali, and which part do I look forward to most?

SLIDE 3 Two ways to keep Diwali



ON THE SLIDE

The slide sets two lamps side by side. The outer lamp is lamps, sweets, new clothes, family and friends: good, and joyful. The inner lamp is a mind clear enough for the light of the Self to shine through.

It also names the festival three ways: Dīpāvalī, the row of lamps; Lakṣmī Pūjā, the worship of the Divine Mother as grace and well-being in much of India; and Kālī Pūjā, kept on the same new moon night in Bengal and in our Order's tradition. This year that night is Sunday 8 November.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Dīpāvalī / दीपावली	the row of lamps, the festival of lights
Lakṣmī Pūjā / लक्ष्मीपूजा	worship of Lakṣmī, grace and prosperity, on the Diwali night
Kālī Pūjā / कालीपूजा	worship of the Divine Mother as Kālī on the new moon night

COMMENTARY

NOT EITHER, BUT BOTH

Nobody is asked to give up the sweets. The shared gladness of the festival is part of its purpose, and the Vedanta teaching does not despise it. The point is that the outer lamp is best understood as a sign. A lamp is lit to push back the dark, and the deeper dark is ignorance of who we are. So the question for the morning is whether, as well as the outer lamp, we light the inner one.

ONE NIGHT, MANY NAMES

On the same new moon night, different regions honour different forms of the Divine Mother: Lakṣmī in much of India, Kālī in Bengal and the east. These are tradition and general knowledge, not quotations from our three books, and the slide says so. For our Order the night is Kālī Pūjā, and it connects this satsang to the class on the Divine Mother Kālī held in Hamilton on 4 November.

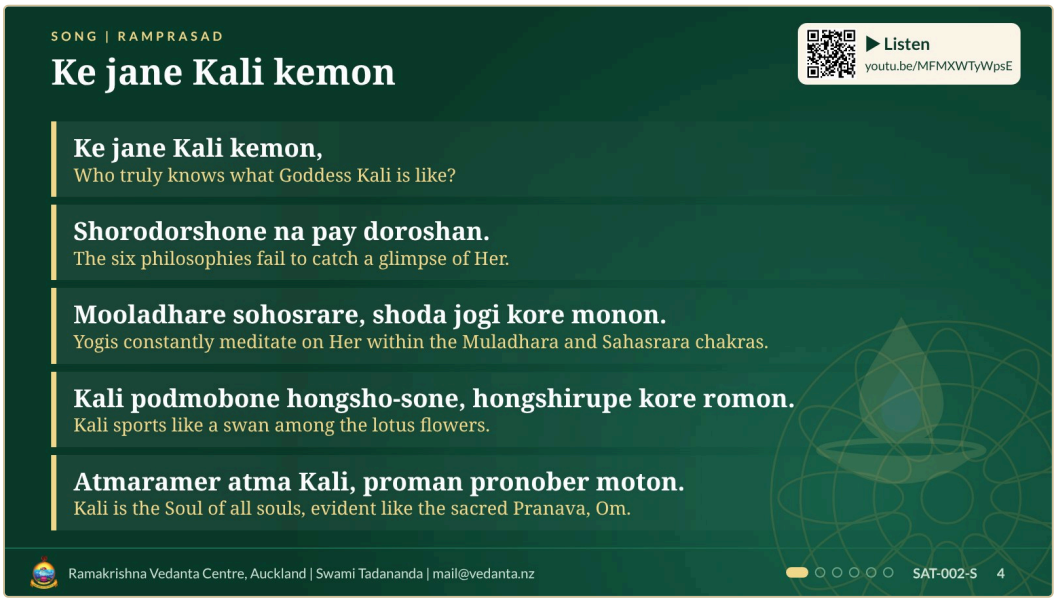
A SMALL EXERCISE

Recall a festival that left you with something lasting inside, not only a good memory of food and company. What was it about that day that went deeper? Often it is a moment of quiet, a kindness given or received, or a sense of belonging to something larger. That is the inner lamp, already burning.

REFLECT

When did a festival leave me with something lasting inside?

SLIDE 4 Song: Ke jane Kali kemon (Bengali and meaning)



ON THE SLIDE

The first stanza lines of Ramprasad's song, in roman Bengali with the meaning of each line: who truly knows what the Goddess Kālī is like? Even the six philosophies fail to catch a glimpse of Her. Yogis meditate on Her constantly in the Muladhara and Sahasrara. Kālī sports like a swan among lotus flowers. She is the Soul of all souls, evident like the sacred Om.

A Listen link and QR code at the foot take you to a recording.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Kālī / काली	the Divine Mother as Time and as the power that dissolves all things into Herself
Ātmārām / आत्माराम	one who delights in the Self; here the Self of the yogi
Praṇava / प्रणव	the sacred syllable Om

COMMENTARY

WHO WAS RAMPRASAD

Ramprasad Sen was a Bengali poet-devotee of the Divine Mother whose songs Sri Ramakrishna loved and sang often. This is one of them. The Gospel records the song, in whole or in part, in several chapters.

READING THE FIRST STANZA

The first line is a question that expects the answer 'no one'. The six classical systems of Indian philosophy (the six darśanas) are skilled at argument, and the song says even they cannot reveal Her. Then it says where

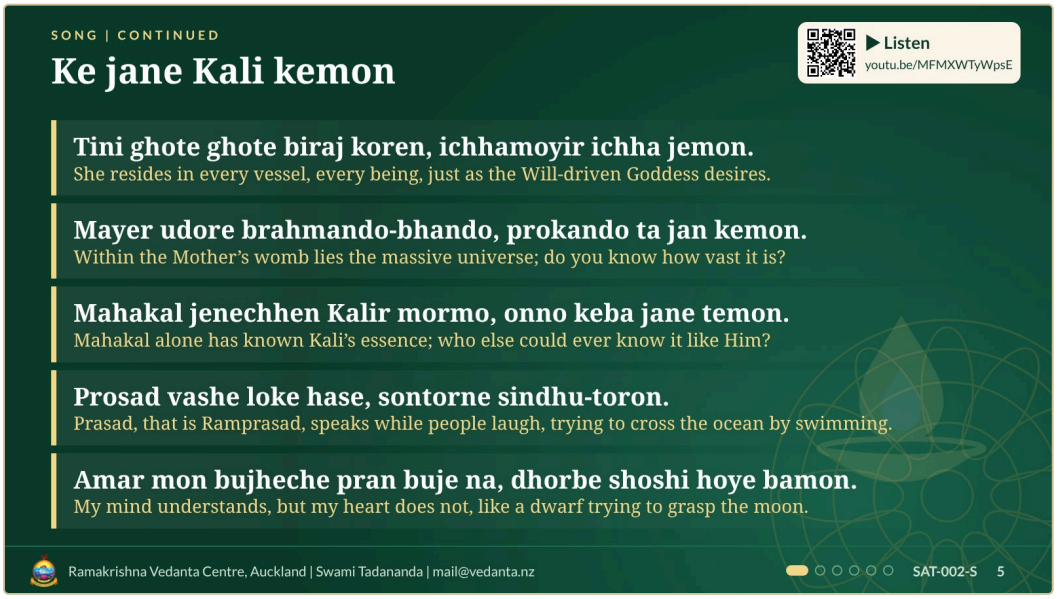
to look: the yogi finds Her in the lowest centre of the subtle body, the Muladhara at the base of the spine, and in the highest, the Sahasrara at the crown. The Mother is not far away; She is the Soul of all souls, the Self.

The swan among the lotuses is a classical image of the soul, free and unstained, moving over water. The song joins that image to the sound of Om.

A NOTE ON THE WORDS

The Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna gives the English of this song, but not the Bengali. The roman Bengali and the line-by-line meanings on these two slides were supplied by Swami Tadananda. Bengali sounds differ from the way the roman letters look to an English reader, so it helps to listen once to the recording before singing.

SLIDE 5 Song: Ke jane Kali kemon (continued)



ON THE SLIDE

The remaining lines: She resides in every vessel, every being, as the Will-driven Goddess desires. Within the Mother's womb lies the massive universe; do you know how vast it is? Mahākāl alone has known Kālī's essence. Ramprasad speaks while people laugh, as one trying to cross the ocean by swimming. And the last lines: my mind understands, but my heart does not, like a dwarf trying to grasp the moon.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Mahākāla / महाकाल	the Great Time; here Śiva, who alone has known Her
Brahmāṇḍa / ब्रह्माण्ड	the egg of Brahmā, the whole universe

COMMENTARY

THE UNIVERSE IN HER WOMB

The Mother is not only the Self inside us; the whole universe rests inside Her. The song asks the listener to feel how vast that is, and the vastness is the reason no scholar can contain Her in a theory.

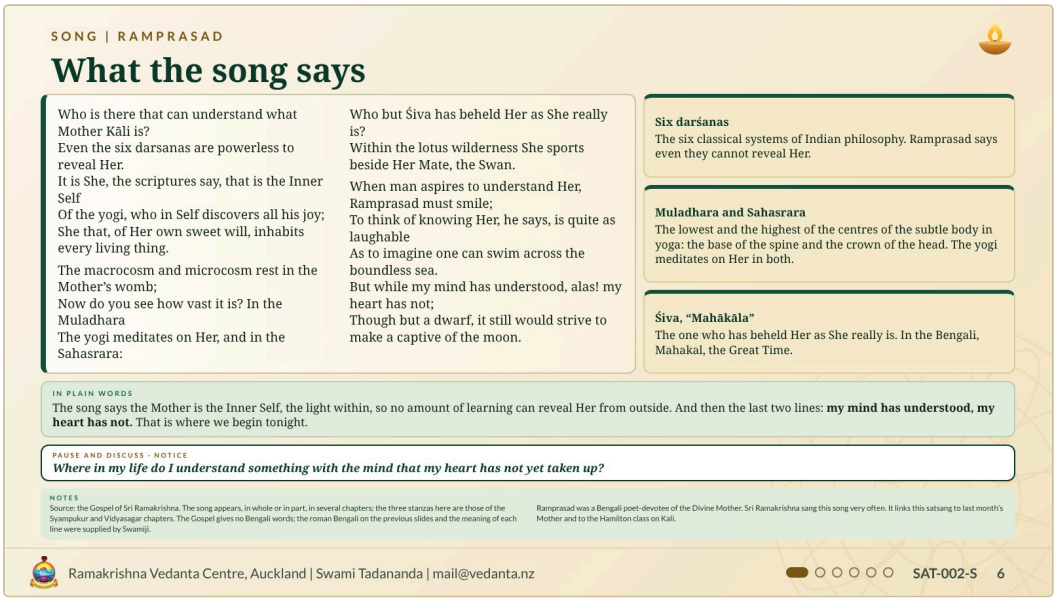
THE LAUGH AND THE SWIMMER

Ramprasad says people laugh at him for trying to know Her, and he agrees with them: it is like trying to swim across the sea. A devotee who knows the limits of the mind is not discouraged by them. The humour is part of the song's humility.

WHERE THE SATSANG BEGINS

The last two lines are the most useful for us. 'My mind understands, but my heart does not.' Most of us have understood the teaching that the light is within us, and we still live as if it were not. The distance between understanding and living is the distance this satsang tries to shorten.

SLIDE 6 What the song says



ON THE SLIDE

Sri Ramakrishna's own English rendering of the song as recorded in the Gospel: Who is there that can understand what Mother Kāli is? Even the six darśanas are powerless to reveal Her. It is She, the scriptures say, that is the Inner Self of the yogi, who in Self discovers all his joy. She, of Her own sweet will, inhabits every living thing. The macrocosm and microcosm rest in the Mother's womb. The yogi meditates on Her in the Muladhara and in the Sahasrara. Who but Śiva has beheld Her as She really is? When man aspires to understand Her, Ramprasad must smile. But while my mind has understood, alas, my heart has not.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Ṣaḍ-darśana / षड्दर्शन	the six classical systems of Indian philosophy
Mūlādhāra / मूलाधार	the lowest centre of the subtle body, at the base of the spine
Sahasrāra / सहस्रार	the highest centre, at the crown of the head

COMMENTARY

THE SONG IN PLAIN WORDS

The song says the Mother is the Inner Self, the light within, so no amount of learning can reveal Her from outside. Knowing about Her is different from knowing Her. The yogi meets Her by turning inward, at the lowest and the highest points of the subtle body, which is another way of saying everywhere between.

Sri Ramakrishna sang this song very often. It links this satsang to last month's satsang on the Mother and to the Hamilton class on Kālī.

WHY IT OPENS THE MORNING

We ask for the light of Diwali from the same Mother whom the song celebrates. And the last two lines name our real situation honestly: we understand with the mind and still wait for the heart to follow. That is where we begin.

GOING DEEPER

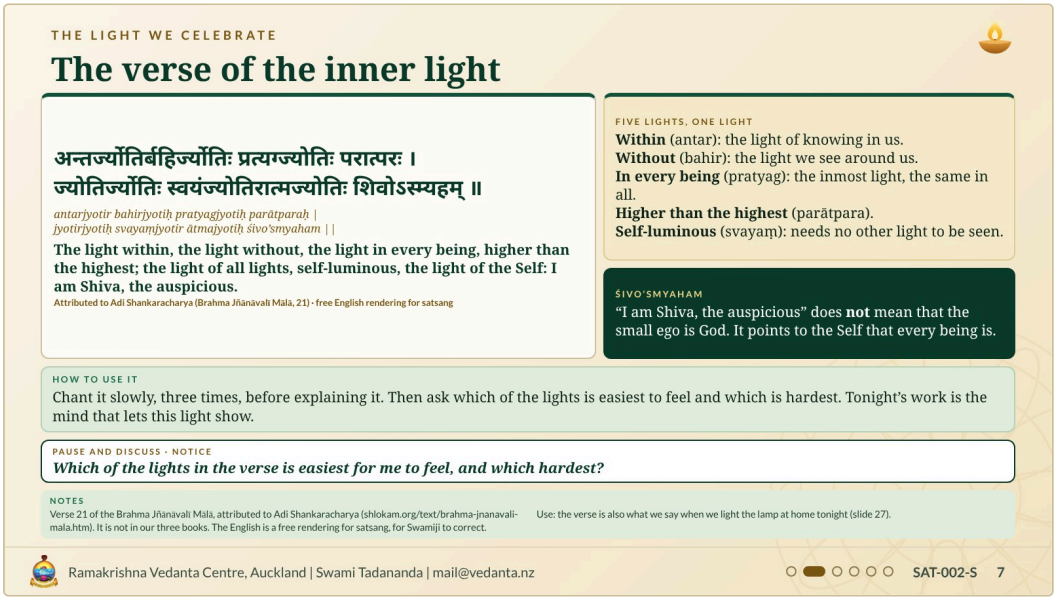
ON THE SOURCE

The three stanzas on these slides are those of the Syampukur and Vidyasagar chapters of the Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna. The Gospel's English is used as written. The roman Bengali on slides 4 and 5 and the meaning of each line were supplied by Swami Tadananda.

REFLECT

Where in my life do I understand something with the mind that my heart has not yet taken up?

SLIDE 7 The verse of the inner light



ON THE SLIDE

A single verse, attributed to Adi Śaṅkarācārya, in Devanagari, roman transliteration and a free English rendering: the light within, the light without, the light in every being, higher than the highest; the light of all lights, self-luminous, the light of the Self: I am Shiva, the auspicious.

The slide names five lights, one Light: within (antar), without (bahir), in every being (pratyag), higher than the highest (parātpara), and self-luminous (svayaṃ). It ends with the reminder that 'I am Shiva' does not mean the small ego is God.

Brahma Jñānāvalī Mālā 21, attributed to Adi Śaṅkarācārya

अन्तर्ज्योतिर्बहिर्ज्योतिः प्रत्यग्ज्योतिः परात्परः ।

ज्योतिर्ज्योतिः स्वयंज्योतिरात्मज्योतिः शिवोऽस्म्यहम् ॥

antarjyotir bahirjyotiḥ pratyagjyotiḥ parātparaḥ |
jyotirjyotiḥ svayaṃjyotir ātmajyotiḥ śivo'smyaham | |

The light within, the light without, the light in every being, higher than the highest; the light of all lights, self-luminous, the light of the Self: I am Shiva, the auspicious. (A free English rendering for satsang.)

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

antar / अन्तर्	within
bahir / बहिः	outside
pratyag / प्रत्यक्	the inmost, the one within each being
parātpara / परात्पर	higher than the highest
svayaṃjyoti / स्वयंज्योतिः	self-luminous, needing no other light
Śivo'smi / शिवोऽस्मि	I am Śiva, the auspicious

COMMENTARY

FIVE LIGHTS, ONE LIGHT

The verse does not describe five different lights. It looks at one light from five sides. The light within is the light of knowing in us. The light without is the light we see around us, the sun, the flame, the lamp. The inmost light is the same in every being. The light higher than the highest is the source of all lights. And the self-luminous light needs no second light to be seen: it is what makes everything else visible, including our own thoughts.

THE LAST WORDS

Śivo'smyaham, 'I am Shiva', is the most easily misunderstood phrase. It does not say that the small, worried ego is God. It points to the Self that every being is, the awareness in which all experience appears. In Vedanta Shiva means the auspicious, the one who is peace itself. To say it is to recognise one's own deepest nature, not to inflate one's personality.

HOW TO USE IT

Chant the verse slowly, three times, before thinking about its meaning. Then ask which light is easiest to feel and which is hardest. For many people the outer lamp is easiest, and the self-luminous light is hardest. That difference is the work. The same verse is said when the lamp is lit at home tonight (slide 27).

GOING DEEPER

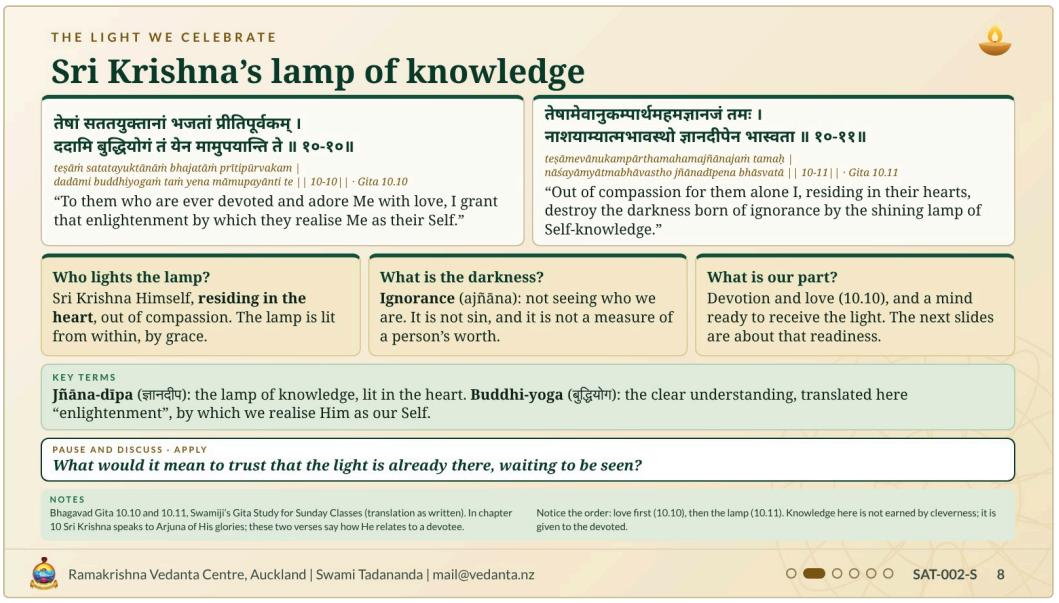
ON THE SOURCE

The verse is verse 21 of the Brahma Jñānāvalī Mālā, attributed to Adi Śaṅkarācārya, and it is not in our three books. The Sanskrit is from the text on shlokam.org. The English is a free rendering for satsang and is open to correction by Swami Tadananda.

REFLECT

Which of the lights in the verse is easiest for me to feel, and which hardest?

SLIDE 8 Sri Krishna's lamp of knowledge: Gita 10.10 and 10.11



ON THE SLIDE

Two verses from chapter 10. In 10.10 Sri Krishna says that to those who are ever devoted and adore Him with love, He grants the enlightenment by which they realise Him as their Self. In 10.11 He says that out of compassion for them alone, He, residing in their hearts, destroys the darkness born of ignorance by the shining lamp of Self-knowledge.

Three questions answer the verses: who lights the lamp (Sri Krishna Himself, from within, by grace), what the darkness is (ignorance, not sin and not a measure of worth), and what our part is (devotion and love, and a mind ready to receive the light).

Bhagavad Gita 10.10

तेषां सततयुक्तानां भजतां प्रीतिपूर्वकम् ।
ददामि बुद्धियोगं तं येन मामुपयान्ति ते ॥ १०-१०॥

teṣāṁ satatayuktānāṁ bhajatāṁ prītipūrvakam |
dadāmi buddhiyogaṁ taṁ yena māmupayānti te || 10-10 ||

"To them who are ever devoted and adore Me with love, I grant that enlightenment by which they realise Me as their Self."

Bhagavad Gita 10.11

तेषामेवानुकम्पार्थमहमज्ञानजं तमः ।
नाशयाम्यात्मभावस्थो ज्ञानदीपेन भास्वता ॥ १०-११॥

teṣāmevānukampārthamahamajñānajaṁ tamaḥ |
nāśayāmyātmabhāvastho jñānadīpena bhāsvatā || 10-11 ||

"Out of compassion for them alone I, residing in their hearts, destroy the darkness born of ignorance by the shining lamp of Self-knowledge."

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

jñāna-dīpa / ज्ञानदीप	the lamp of knowledge, lit in the heart
buddhi-yoga / बुद्धियोग	the clear understanding by which one realises Him as the Self
ajñāna / अज्ञान	ignorance, not knowing who we are
ātma-bhāva-sthaḥ / आत्मभावस्थः	residing in the heart as the Self

COMMENTARY

WHO LIGHTS THE LAMP

The verse is surprising. We expect to light our own lamp by effort. Here Sri Krishna says He lights it, from within the heart, out of compassion. The lamp of Self-knowledge is a gift. The devotee's part is to be ever devoted and loving, so that the gift can be received.

WHAT THE DARKNESS IS

The darkness is called ajñāna-ja, born of ignorance. It is not described as wickedness and it does not make us unworthy. It is simply not seeing who we are. A dark room is not a bad room; it needs a light. This matters because many people feel that the distance between them and the Divine is a moral failure. The Gita treats it as a lack of light, and light is given.

NOTICE THE ORDER

Love comes first (10.10), then the lamp (10.11). Knowledge here is not won by cleverness. It is given to the devoted. This is a good verse to hold alongside the song just sung: the mind may understand a little, and the heart is moved by love, which opens it to receive.

GOING DEEPER

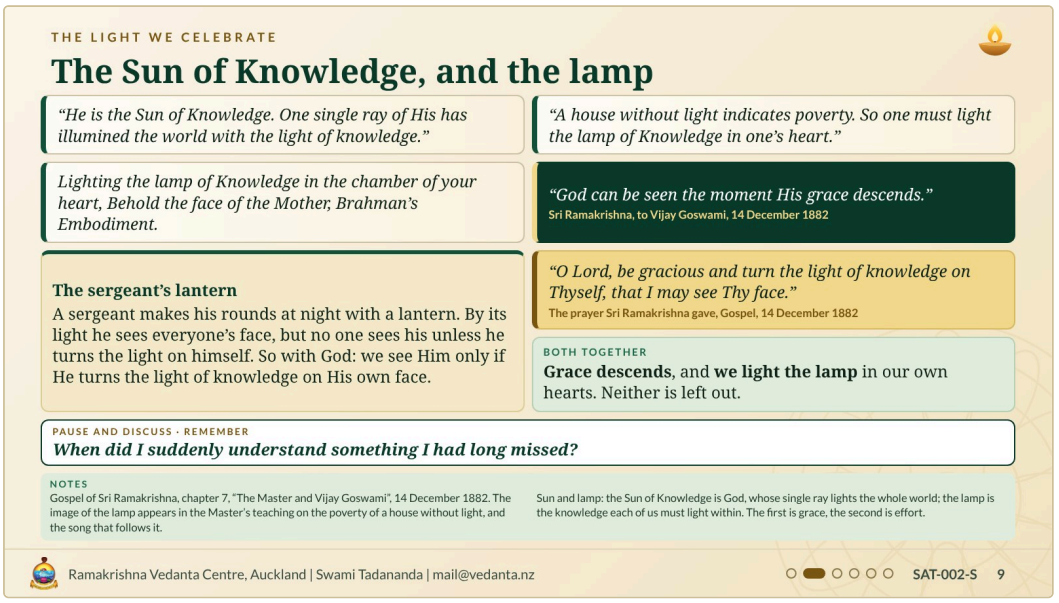
CONTEXT IN CHAPTER 10

Chapter 10 is the chapter of divine glories (vibhūti). Arjuna asks Sri Krishna to describe where he can think of Him. Before the long list of glories begins, the Lord tells Arjuna how the devoted relate to Him. These two verses come from that opening.

REFLECT

What would it mean to trust that the light is already there, waiting to be seen?

SLIDE 9 The Sun of Knowledge, and the lamp



ON THE SLIDE

Sri Ramakrishna: 'He is the Sun of Knowledge. One single ray of His has illumined the world with the light of knowledge.' And: 'A house without light indicates poverty. So one must light the lamp of Knowledge in one's heart.' A short song follows: lighting the lamp of Knowledge in the chamber of your heart, behold the face of the Mother, Brahman's Embodiment.

He also tells the parable of the sergeant's lantern: a sergeant makes his rounds at night with a lantern; by its light he sees everyone's face, but no one sees his unless he turns the light on himself. So with God: we see Him only if He turns the light of knowledge on His own face. The prayer: 'O Lord, be gracious and turn the light of knowledge on Thyself, that I may see Thy face.'

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

jñāna-sūrya	the Sun of Knowledge, God as the source of all knowing
jñāna-dīpa	the lamp of knowledge, kindled in the heart

COMMENTARY

SUN AND LAMP

The Sun of Knowledge is God, whose single ray lights the whole world. The lamp is the knowledge each of us must light in our own heart. The first is grace, the second is effort. The Master speaks of both in the same breath because both are true.

THE SERGEANT'S LANTERN

The image is simple and exact. The sergeant lights everyone's face but not his own. We can see the world because He lights it; we cannot see Him unless He turns the light round. So the prayer is a prayer of humility and trust: not 'let me find You', but 'turn the light on Yourself, that I may see'. It also fits the Gita verses on the previous slide, where the Lord Himself destroys the darkness by the lamp of knowledge.

BOTH TOGETHER

Grace descends, and we light the lamp in our own hearts. Neither is left out. 'God can be seen the moment His grace descends' (Sri Ramakrishna to Vijay Goswami, 14 December 1882). A person who waits for grace without lighting any lamp has misunderstood the Master; a person who lights a lamp and forgets grace has misunderstood him just as much.

GOING DEEPER

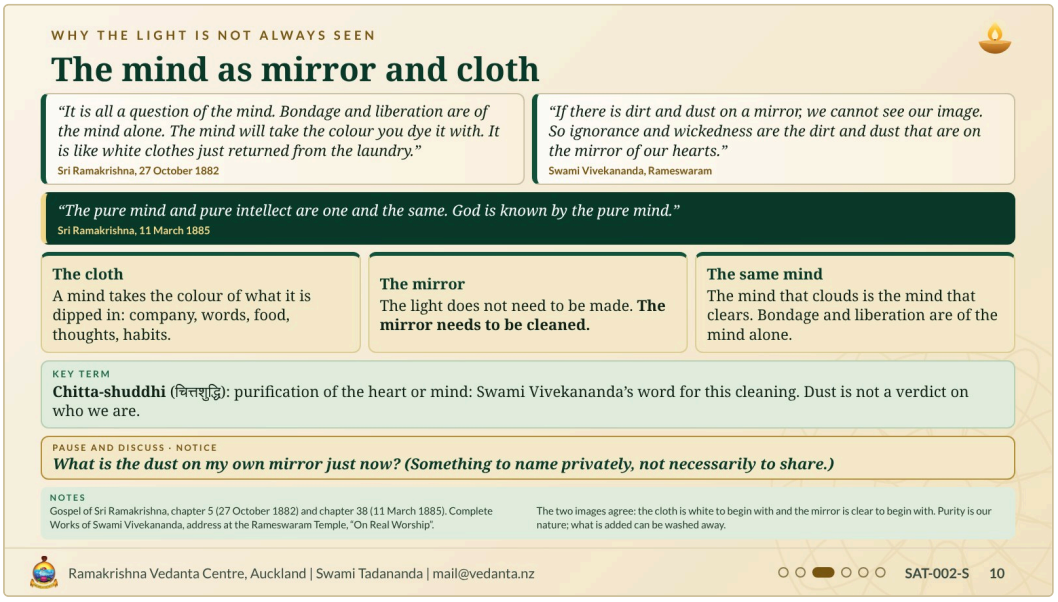
ON THE SOURCE

Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, chapter 7, 'The Master and Vijay Goswami', 14 December 1882. The image of the lamp appears in the Master's teaching on the poverty of a house without light, and in the song that follows it.

REFLECT

When did I suddenly understand something I had long missed?

SLIDE 10 The mind as mirror and cloth



ON THE SLIDE

Three quotations. Sri Ramakrishna: 'It is all a question of the mind. Bondage and liberation are of the mind alone. The mind will take the colour you dye it with. It is like white clothes just returned from the laundry.' Swami Vivekananda at Rameswaram: 'If there is dirt and dust on a mirror, we cannot see our image. So ignorance and wickedness are the dirt and dust that are on the mirror of our hearts.' Sri Ramakrishna: 'The pure mind and pure intellect are one and the same. God is known by the pure mind.'

Three boxes: the cloth takes the colour of what it is dipped in; the mirror does not need the light made, only the glass cleaned; and the same mind that clouds can clear.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

citta-śuddhi / चित्तशुद्धि	purification of the heart or mind: Swami Vivekananda's word for this cleaning
ajñāna / अज्ञान	ignorance, the dust on the mirror

COMMENTARY

TWO PICTURES, ONE TEACHING

The cloth and the mirror agree. The cloth is white to begin with, and the mirror is clear to begin with. Purity is our nature. What is added can be washed away. This is a hopeful teaching: the work is not to become something new but to remove what covers what we are.

THE CLOTH

White cloth takes whatever dye it is dipped in. So does the mind. Company, conversation, what we read and watch, what we eat, the thoughts we repeat, and the habits we feed all colour it. This is why Sri Ramakrishna says the mind is everything. It is also why we can change: the colour is not permanent, and a new dye can be chosen.

THE MIRROR

A mirror with dust shows a poor image, but nobody concludes the mirror is bad. Swami Vivekananda says ignorance and wickedness are the dust. The word 'wickedness' is strong, but the point of the image is that dust is on the surface and can be wiped. Dust is not a verdict on who we are.

A PRIVATE QUESTION

What is the dust on my own mirror just now? Name it privately: a worry, a resentment, a habit, a screen, a way of speaking. It does not have to be shared. Naming it is the first act of cleaning.

GOING DEEPER

ON THE SOURCES

Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, chapter 5 (27 October 1882) for the white cloth, and chapter 38 (11 March 1885) for the pure mind. Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda, address at the Rameswaram Temple, 'On Real Worship', for the mirror.

REFLECT

What is the dust on my own mirror just now? (Something to name privately, not necessarily to share.)

SLIDE 11 Chitta-shuddhi in the Gita (5.11 and 16.1)



ON THE SLIDE

Two verses. Gita 5.11: by giving up attachment, the karma-yogis undertake work merely through the body, mind, intellect and even the senses for the purification of the heart (mind and intellect). Gita 16.1: fearlessness, purity of mind, persistence in knowledge and yoga, charity and control of the external organs, sacrifice, scriptural study, austerity and rectitude.

Swami Vivekananda is quoted: 'The purer the mind, the easier it is to control.' The slide's plain words: purity is not an extra; it is where the list starts.

Bhagavad Gita 5.11

कायेन मनसा बुद्ध्या केवलैरिन्द्रियैरपि ।

योगिनः कर्म कुर्वन्ति सङ्गं त्यक्त्वात्मशुद्धये ॥ ५-११॥

kāyena manasā buddhyā kevalairindriyairapi |
yoginaḥ karma kurvanti saṅgaṁ tyaktvātmaśuddhaye || 5-11||

“By giving up attachment, the Karma-yogis undertake work merely through the body, mind, intellect and even the senses for the purification of the heart (mind and intellect).”

Bhagavad Gita 16.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

अभयं सत्त्वसंशुद्धिर्ज्ञानयोगव्यवस्थितिः ।

दानं दमश्च यज्ञश्च स्वाध्यायस्तप आर्जवम् ॥ १६-१॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
abhayaṁ sattvasaṁśuddhirjñānayogavyavasthitiḥ |
dānaṁ damaśca yajñaśca svādhyāyastapa ārjavam || 16-1||

“Fearlessness, purity of mind, persistence in knowledge and yoga, charity and control of the external organs, sacrifice, (scriptural) study, austerity and rectitude;”

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

ātma-śuddhi / आत्मशुद्धि	purification of the self or heart (5.11)
sattva-saṁśuddhi / सत्त्वसंशुद्धि	complete purification of the mind (16.1)
abhaya / अभय	fearlessness
svādhyāya / स्वाध्याय	study of the scriptures, and of oneself

COMMENTARY

THE SAME IDEA, TWICE

The Gita names the work in two places. In 5.11 the karma-yogis work 'for the purification of the heart': the purpose of their action is not the result but the cleaning of the mind. In 16.1 purity of mind (sattva-saṁśuddhi) is the second item in the list of divine qualities, after fearlessness. Purity is not an extra; it is where the list starts.

WHY IT COMES FIRST

Swami Vivekananda says the purer the mind, the easier it is to control. If purity came after the other qualities, we would have to build them on a muddy base. Placed early, it says: clear the glass first, and the rest of the divine qualities become visible.

ONE QUESTION

If purity of mind comes first in the Gita's list, what would I put first in my own week? A small honest answer is better than a large impressive one.

GOING DEEPER

ON THE SOURCES

Bhagavad Gita 5.11 and 16.1 in Swami Tadananda's Gita Study; the translation is as written there. Swami Vivekananda: Complete Works, Raja Yoga.

REFLECT

If purity of mind comes first in the Gita's list, what would I put first in my own week?

SLIDE 12 Clearing the mirror, in our course's words



ON THE SLIDE

The old image is dust on a mirror: ignorance and wickedness cover the glass, so we cannot see our own image. The course's image is noise on a signal: the noise of a busy, conditioned mind hides the signal. Lowering the noise floor lets the subtle signal (stillness, the witness) become audible.

The slide lists what lowers the noise: meditation, breath regulation, ethical living, repetition of sacred names, silence and simplicity. It adds two cautions: it is not a verdict ('neither of these people is morally superior or inferior') and it is lifelong and gentle.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

noise floor	in the course: the background level of mental noise below which a subtle signal cannot be heard
citta-śuddhi / चित्तशुद्धि	the old name for the same clearing

COMMENTARY

TWO LANGUAGES, ONE POINT

The mirror is the language of the Upanishads and the Gospel. The signal and noise is the language of our course, The Mind in the Light of Modern and Spiritual Sciences. Both say the same thing: the Light is not what is missing; the clarity of the instrument is. A radio can only play a station that is there, and a station can only be heard over a quiet room.

WHAT LOWERS THE NOISE

The slide gives five. Meditation and breath regulation work on the mind directly. Ethical living reduces the noise we create by what we do and say. Repetition of sacred names steadies attention. Silence and simplicity remove what is not needed. Most of us already use two or three; the later slides on the seven doors ask which two we will keep.

NOT A VERDICT

The course says plainly that a difference in noise is not a difference in worth. A person with a noisier mind is not morally lower. Chitta-shuddhi is not self-punishment and not perfection by Sunday. It is a daily clearing, done kindly.

GOING DEEPER

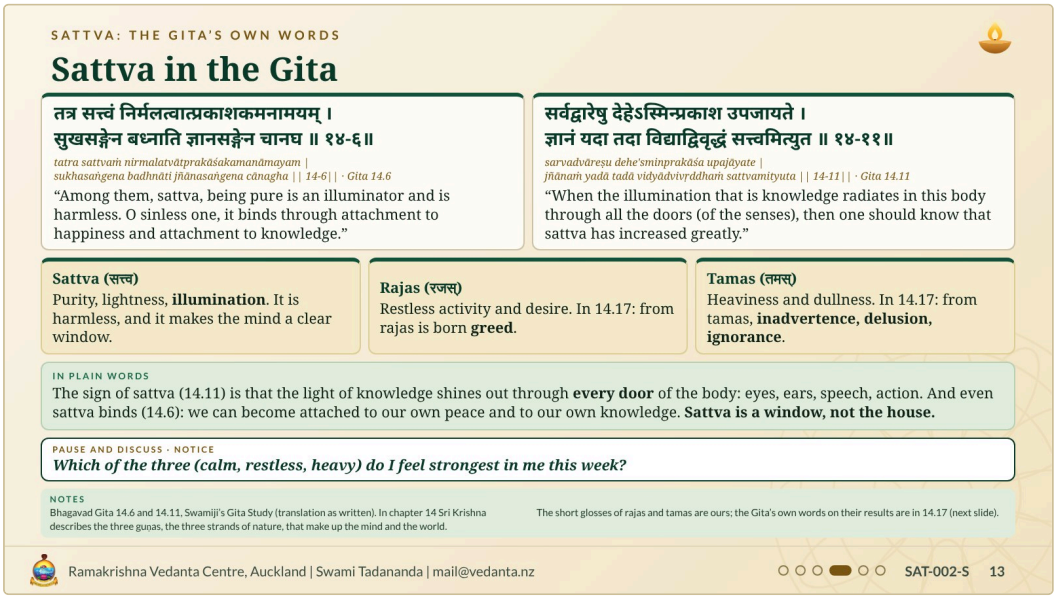
IF YOU WANT TO GO FURTHER

The course lessons are Lesson 3.4, 'Signal and Noise', and Lesson 3.6, 'Resonance, Rhythm and Coherence'. They are written in the course's own terms and are worth reading step by step.

REFLECT

What one thing clouds my mind most often, and what clears it?

SLIDE 13 Sattva in the Gita (14.6 and 14.11)



ON THE SLIDE

Two verses from chapter 14, the chapter of the three guṇas. Gita 14.6: among them, sattva, being pure, is an illuminator and is harmless; it binds through attachment to happiness and attachment to knowledge. Gita 14.11: when the illumination that is knowledge radiates in this body through all the doors of the senses, then one should know that sattva has increased greatly.

Three short glosses: sattva is purity, lightness and illumination; rajas is restless activity and desire (greed, 14.17); tamas is heaviness and dullness (inadvertence, delusion, ignorance, 14.17).

Bhagavad Gita 14.6

तत्र सत्त्वं निर्मलत्वात्प्रकाशकमनामयम् ।

सुखसङ्गेन बध्नाति ज्ञानसङ्गेन चानघ ॥ १४-६॥

tatra sattvaṁ nirmalatvātprakāśakamanāmayam |
sukhasaṅgena badhnāti jñānasaṅgena cānagha || 14-6||

"Among them, sattva, being pure is an illuminator and is harmless. O sinless one, it binds through attachment to happiness and attachment to knowledge."

Bhagavad Gita 14.11

सर्वद्वारेषु देहेऽस्मिन्प्रकाश उपजायते ।

ज्ञानं यदा तदा विद्याद्विवृद्धं सत्त्वमित्युत ॥ १४-११॥

sarvadvāreṣu dehe'sminprakāśa upajāyate |
jñānaṁ yadā tadā vidyādvivṛddhaṁ sattvamityuta || 14-11||

“When the illumination that is knowledge radiates in this body through all the doors (of the senses), then one should know that sattva has increased greatly.”

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

sattva / सत्त्व	purity, lightness, illumination
rajas / रजस्	restless activity, desire
tamas / तमस्	heaviness, dullness
guṇa / गुण	one of the three strands of nature that make up mind and world
prakāśa / प्रकाश	light, illumination

COMMENTARY

THE THREE GUṆAS IN ONE LINE EACH

The Gita says the mind and the world are woven of three strands, the guṇas. Sattva is clarity and light, rajas is restless desire and action, and tamas is dullness and inertia. Every mind has all three. Which one leads varies, and our practice affects which one leads.

THE SIGN OF SATTVA (14.11)

The sign that sattva has grown is that knowledge shines out through every door of the body: eyes, ears, speech, action. It is not a private feeling of calm; it shows in how we see, hear, speak and act.

EVEN SATTVA BINDS (14.6)

The verse also warns that sattva binds, through attachment to happiness and to knowledge. We can become attached to our own peace and to our own understanding, and then feel superior or protective of them. Sattva is a window, not the house: it lets the light through, but we are not meant to stay looking at the window. This is why the Gita goes on beyond the guṇas.

GOING DEEPER

ON THE GLOSSES

The short glosses of rajas and tamas on the slide are ours. The Gita's own words on their results are in 14.17, which is the next slide.

REFLECT

Which of the three (calm, restless, heavy) do I feel strongest in me this week?

SLIDE 14 The three rise and fall (14.10, 14.17, 14.18)



ON THE SLIDE

Gita 14.10: sattva increases by subduing rajas and tamas, rajas by overpowering sattva and tamas, and tamas by dominating over sattva and rajas. Gita 14.17: from sattva is born knowledge; from rajas, greed; from tamas, inadvertence, delusion and ignorance. Gita 14.18: those who conform to sattva go higher up; those who conform to rajas stay in the middle; those who conform to tamas go down.

Bhagavad Gita 14.10

रजस्तमश्चाभिभूय सत्त्वं भवति भारत ।

रजः सत्त्वं तमश्चैव तमः सत्त्वं रजस्तथा ॥ १४-१०॥

rajastamaścābhibhūya sattvaṁ bhavati bhārata |
rajaḥ sattvaṁ tamaścaiva tamaḥ sattvaṁ rajastathā || 14-10||

"O scion of the Bharata dynasty, sattva increases by subduing rajas and tamas, rajas by over-powering sattva and tamas and tamas by dominating over sattva and rajas."

Bhagavad Gita 14.17

सत्त्वात्सञ्जायते ज्ञानं रजसो लोभ एव च ।

प्रमादमोहौ तमसो भवतोऽज्ञानमेव च ॥ १४-१७॥

sattvātsañjāyate jñānaṁ rajaso lobha eva ca |
pramādamohau tamaso bhavato'jñānameva ca || 14-17||

"From sattva is born knowledge, and from rajas, verily greed. From tamas are born inadvertence, delusion and ignorance to be sure."

Bhagavad Gita 14.18

ऊर्ध्वं गच्छन्ति सत्त्वस्था मध्ये तिष्ठन्ति राजसाः ।

जघन्यगुणवृत्तिस्था अधो गच्छन्ति तामसाः ॥ १४-१८॥

ūrdhvaṁ gacchanti sattvasthā madhye tiṣṭhanti rājasāḥ |
jaghanyaguṇavṛttisthā adho gacchanti tāmasāḥ || 14-18||

“People who conform to sattva go higher up; those who conform to rajas stay in the middle; those who conform to tamas, who conform to the actions of the lowest quality, go down.”

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

abhibhūya / अभिभूय	having overpowered
pramāda / प्रमाद	inadvertence, carelessness
moha / मोह	delusion
lobha / लोभ	greed
ūrdhvam / ऊर्ध्वम्	upward

COMMENTARY

NO ONE IS ONLY ONE

Verse 14.10 says each guṇa rises by overpowering the other two. That means all three are always present, and one is on top at a given time. A person is not 'a sattvic type' or 'a tamasic type'. The same person is clear in the morning, restless at noon and dull at night, and these shift with what we feed them.

WHAT EACH PRODUCES (14.17)

From sattva comes knowledge. From rajas comes greed. From tamas come carelessness, delusion and ignorance. The verse is useful as a mirror: after a bad afternoon, was it greed or dullness? Naming the guṇa is not blame; it tells us what to feed less.

THE DIRECTION (14.18)

The upward, middle and downward movements describe a direction of life, not a ranking of people. The practical meaning is that sattva leads upward and the others do not, so tilting the balance toward sattva is the work of daily practice.

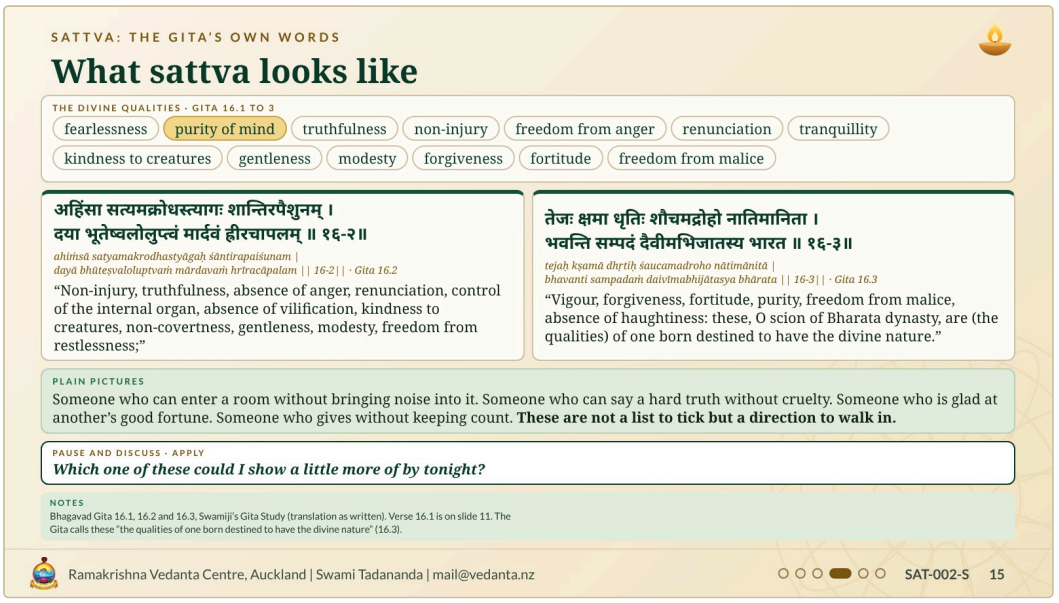
WHAT WE FEED

'What we feed it' is our reading of 14.10 and it is why daily practice matters. Company, food, speech and thought feed one guṇa or another. A small, consistent change in what we feed tilts the balance more than an occasional large effort.

REFLECT

What fed my restlessness or my heaviness this week, and what fed my calm?

SLIDE 15 What sattva looks like: the divine qualities (16.1 to 3)



ON THE SLIDE

The divine qualities of Gita 16.1 to 3, shown as a word cloud: fearlessness, purity of mind, truthfulness, non-injury, freedom from anger, renunciation, tranquillity, kindness to creatures, gentleness, modesty, forgiveness, fortitude, freedom from malice. Verses 16.2 and 16.3 are given in full: non-injury, truthfulness, absence of anger, renunciation, control of the internal organ, absence of vilification, kindness to creatures, non-covertness, gentleness, modesty, freedom from restlessness; vigour, forgiveness, fortitude, purity, freedom from malice, absence of haughtiness; these are the qualities of one born destined to have the divine nature.

Four plain pictures follow: someone who can enter a room without bringing noise into it; someone who can say a hard truth without cruelty; someone glad at another's good fortune; someone who gives without keeping count.

Bhagavad Gita 16.2

अहिंसा सत्यमक्रोधस्त्यागः शान्तिरपैशुनम् ।

दया भूतेष्वलोलुप्त्वं मार्दवं ह्रीरचापलम् ॥ १६-२॥

ahiṁsā satyamakrodhastyāgaḥ śāntirapaiśunam |
dayā bhūteṣvaloluptvaṁ mārdavaṁ hrīracāpalam || 16-2 ||

"Non-injury, truthfulness, absence of anger, renunciation, control of the internal organ, absence of vilification, kindness to creatures, non-covertness, gentleness, modesty, freedom from restlessness;"

Bhagavad Gita 16.3

तेजः क्षमा धृतिः शौचमद्रोहो नातिमानिता ।

भवन्ति सम्पदं दैवीमभिजातस्य भारत ॥ १६-३॥

tejaḥ kṣamā dhṛtiḥ śaucamadroho nātimānitā |
bhavanti sampadaṁ daivīmabhijātasya bhārata || 16-3 ||

"Vigour, forgiveness, fortitude, purity, freedom from malice, absence of haughtiness: these, O scion of Bharata dynasty, are (the qualities) of one born destined to have the divine nature."

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

ahiṁsā / अहिंसा	non-injury
satyam / सत्यम्	truthfulness
akrodha / अक्रोध	absence of anger
tyāga / त्याग	renunciation
śānti / शान्ति	tranquillity
dayā / दया	kindness to creatures
mārdava / मार्दव	gentleness
kṣamā / क्षमा	forgiveness
daivī sampad / दैवी सम्पद्	the divine wealth, the divine nature

COMMENTARY

A DIRECTION, NOT A CHECKLIST

The list is long, and nobody has all of it. It is a picture of what the mind looks like when it is clear. The Gita calls these qualities the wealth of one 'born destined to have the divine nature', and the word 'destined' is encouraging: they are our inheritance, not a prize for the exceptional.

PLAIN PICTURES

Abstract words are hard to practise. The four pictures on the slide turn them into daily scenes. Entering a room without bringing noise is śānti and absence of restlessness. Saying a hard truth without cruelty is truthfulness together with non-injury. Being glad at another's good fortune is freedom from malice. Giving without keeping count is renunciation and kindness. Which scene could you act out today?

A NOTE ON TRANSLATION

The English is as given in Swami Tadananda's Gita Study. Two phrases need a word. 'Absence of vilification' translates apaiśunam: not speaking ill of others behind their backs. 'Non-covertness' translates aloluptvam, which in plain terms means freedom from greedy craving. The slide's plain pictures aim at that sense.

GOING DEEPER

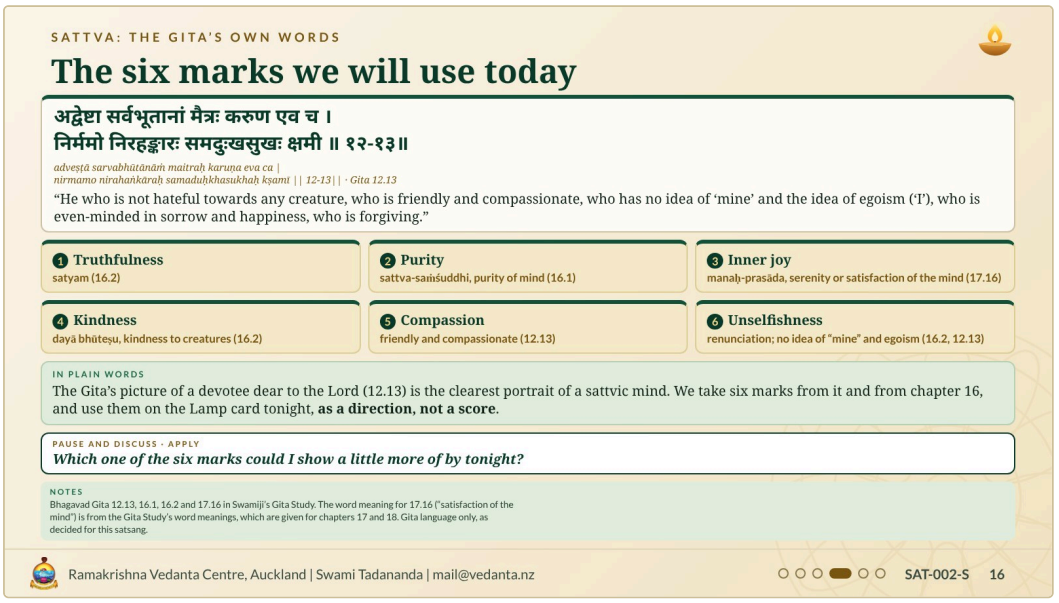
ON VERSE 16.1

Verse 16.1 is on slide 11. The chapter goes on from 16.4 to describe the opposite, the demoniac nature, which should be read with the same gentleness: the Gita lists these as tendencies of the mind, not as classes of people we are entitled to judge.

REFLECT

Which one of these could I show a little more of by tonight?

SLIDE 16 The six marks we will use today (12.13)



ON THE SLIDE

Gita 12.13: he who is not hateful towards any creature, who is friendly and compassionate, who has no idea of 'mine' and the idea of egoism ('I'), who is even-minded in sorrow and happiness, who is forgiving.

From this verse and from chapter 16 and 17.16 we take six marks to use on the Lamp card: truthfulness (satyam, 16.2), purity (sattva-saṁśuddhi, 16.1), inner joy (manaḥ-prasāda, 17.16), kindness (dayā bhūteṣu, 16.2), compassion (friendly and compassionate, 12.13), and unselfishness (renunciation, no idea of 'mine' and egoism, 16.2 and 12.13).

> **Bhagavad Gita 12.13**
>
> अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च ।
>
> निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी ॥ १२-१३॥
>
> *adveṣṭā sarvabhūtānāṁ maitraḥ karuṇa eva ca |*
> *nirmamo nirahaṅkāraḥ samaduḥkhasukhaḥ kṣamī || 12-13 ||*
>
> "He who is not hateful towards any creature, who is friendly and compassionate, who has no idea of 'mine' and the idea of egoism ('I'), who is even-minded in sorrow and happiness, who is forgiving."

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

adveṣṭā / अद्वेष्टा	not hating any being
maitraḥ / मैत्रः	friendly
karuṇaḥ / करुणः	compassionate
nirmamaḥ / निर्ममः	without 'mine'
nirahaṅkāraḥ / निरहङ्कारः	without egoism
kṣamī / क्षमी	forgiving
manaḥ-prasāda / मनःप्रसाद	serenity or satisfaction of the mind

COMMENTARY

A PORTRAIT OF A CLEAR MIND

Chapter 12 describes the devotee dear to the Lord. The portrait is not of a person who has special experiences; it is of a person who has no hatred, who is friendly and compassionate, free from 'mine' and 'I', even-minded in joy and sorrow, and forgiving. That is the clearest portrait of a sattvic mind in the Gita, and so we use it.

WHY SIX MARKS

Sixteen divine qualities are too many to keep in view. Six are enough for a card you keep in the shrine: truthfulness, purity, inner joy, kindness, compassion, unselfishness. The six are chosen by us, from the Gita's lists, for use tonight. They are a direction and not a score.

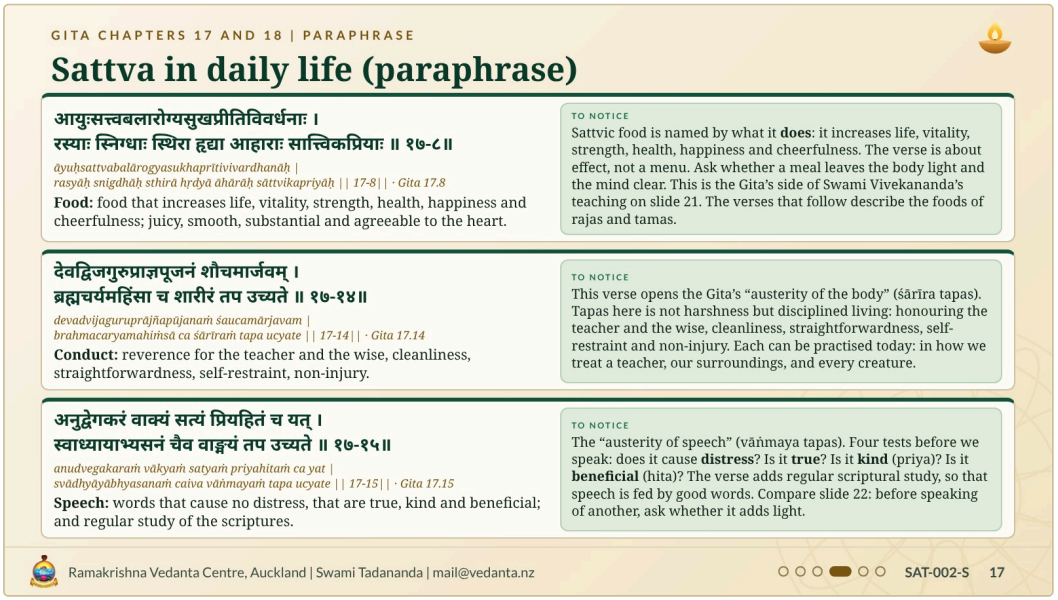
A NOTE ON THE WORD MEANING

The meaning of manaḥ-prasāda as 'serenity or satisfaction of the mind' comes from the word meanings in Swami Tadananda's Gita Study, which are given for chapters 17 and 18. The slide keeps to the Gita's language only, as decided for this satsang.

REFLECT

Which one of the six marks could I show a little more of by tonight?

SLIDE 17 — Sattva in daily life: food, conduct, speech (17.8, 17.14, 17.15)



ON THE SLIDE

Three verses from chapter 17, given with the English as our paraphrase. Food: increases life, vitality, strength, health, happiness and cheerfulness; juicy, smooth, substantial and agreeable to the heart. Conduct: reverence for the teacher and the wise, cleanliness, straightforwardness, self-restraint, non-injury. Speech: words that cause no distress, that are true, kind and beneficial; and regular study of the scriptures.

Beside each verse, a short note says what to notice.

Bhagavad Gita 17.8

आयुःसत्त्वबलारोग्यसुखप्रीतिविवर्धनाः ।

रस्याः स्निग्धाः स्थिरा हृद्या आहाराः सात्त्विकप्रियाः ॥ १७-८॥

āyuḥsattvabalārogyasukhaprītivivardhanāḥ |
rasyāḥ snigdhāḥ sthirā hṛdyā āhārāḥ sāttvikapriyāḥ || 17-8||

Food: food that increases life, vitality, strength, health, happiness and cheerfulness; juicy, smooth, substantial and agreeable to the heart. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 17.14

देवद्विजगुरुप्राज्ञपूजनं शौचमार्जवम् ।

ब्रह्मचर्यमहिंसा च शारीरं तप उच्यते ॥ १७-१४॥

devadvijaguruprājñapūjanaṁ śaucamārjavam |
brahmacaryamahiṁsā ca śārīraṁ tapa ucyate || 17-14||

Conduct: reverence for the teacher and the wise, cleanliness, straightforwardness, self-restraint, non-injury. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 17.15

अनुद्वेगकरं वाक्यं सत्यं प्रियहितं च यत् ।

स्वाध्यायाभ्यसनं चैव वाङ्मयं तप उच्यते ॥ १७-१५॥

anudvegakaraṁ vākyaṁ satyaṁ priyahitaṁ ca yat |
svādhyāyābhyasanaṁ caiva vāṅmayaṁ tapa ucyate || 17-15||

Speech: words that cause no distress, that are true, kind and beneficial; and regular study of the scriptures. (our paraphrase)

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

āhāra / आहार	food, and by extension whatever we take in
śaucam / शौचम्	cleanliness, purity
ārjavam / आर्जवम्	straightforwardness
tapas / तपस्	austerity, disciplined living
svādhyāya / स्वाध्याय	study of the scriptures

COMMENTARY

FOOD: BY WHAT IT DOES

Sattvic food is named by its effect: it increases life, vitality, strength, health, happiness and cheerfulness. The verse is about effect, not a menu. A useful test is whether a meal leaves the body light and the mind clear. This is the Gita's side of Swami Vivekananda's teaching that we must use the food which brings us the purest mind (slide 21). The following verses describe the foods of rajas and tamas.

CONDUCT: AUSTERITY OF THE BODY

Verse 17.14 opens the Gita's 'austerity of the body'. Tapas here is not harshness; it is disciplined living: honouring the teacher and the wise, cleanliness, straightforwardness, self-restraint and non-injury. Each can be practised today, in how we treat a teacher, our surroundings and every creature.

SPEECH: FOUR TESTS

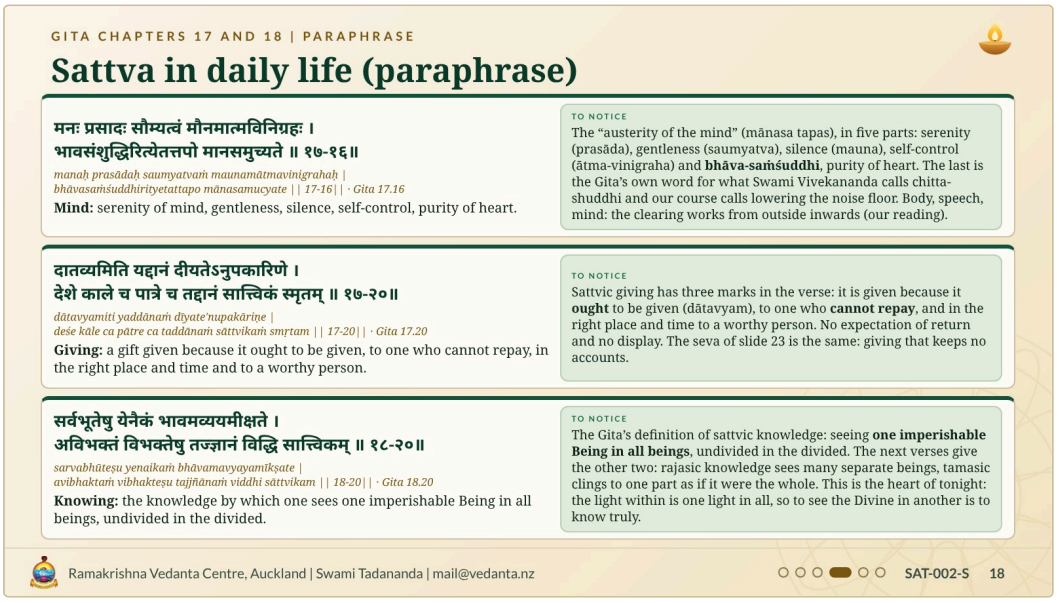
Verse 17.15 gives the austerity of speech. Before we speak, four tests: does it cause distress? Is it true? Is it kind? Is it beneficial? The verse adds regular scriptural study, so that speech is fed by good words. Compare slide 22: before speaking of another, ask whether it adds light.

GOING DEEPER

ON THE ENGLISH

The English on these three slides is our paraphrase, not a quotation. It follows the word meanings of Swami Tadananda's Gita Study, and the slide band says 'paraphrase' to make that plain.

SLIDE 18 — Sattva in daily life: mind and giving, knowing (17.16, 17.20, 18.20)



ON THE SLIDE

Mind (17.16): serenity of mind, gentleness, silence, self-control, purity of heart. Giving (17.20): a gift given because it ought to be given, to one who cannot repay, in the right place and time and to a worthy person. Knowing (18.20): the knowledge by which one sees one imperishable Being in all beings, undivided in the divided.

> **Bhagavad Gita 17.16**
>
> मनः प्रसादः सौम्यत्वं मौनमात्मविनिग्रहः ।
>
> भावसंशुद्धिरित्येतत्तपो मानसमुच्यते ॥ १७-१६॥
>
> *manaḥ prasādaḥ saumyatvaṁ maunamātmavinigrahaḥ |*
> *bhāvasaṁśuddhirityetattapo mānasamucyate || 17-16||*
>
> Mind: serenity of mind, gentleness, silence, self-control, purity of heart. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 17.20

दातव्यमिति यद्दानं दीयतेऽनुपकारिणे ।

देशे काले च पात्रे च तद्दानं सात्त्विकं स्मृतम् ॥ १७-२०॥

dātavyamiti yaddānaṁ dīyate'nupakāriṇe |
deśe kāle ca pātre ca taddānaṁ sāttvikaṁ smṛtam || 17-20||

Giving: a gift given because it ought to be given, to one who cannot repay, in the right place and time and to a worthy person. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 18.20

सर्वभूतेषु येनैकं भावमव्ययमीक्षते ।

अविभक्तं विभक्तेषु तज्ज्ञानं विद्धि सात्त्विकम् ॥ १८-२०॥

sarvabhūteṣu yenaikaṁ bhāvamavyayamīkṣate |
avibhaktaṁ vibhakteṣu tajjñānaṁ viddhi sāttvikam || 18-20||

Knowing: the knowledge by which one sees one imperishable Being in all beings, undivided in the divided. (our paraphrase)

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

mānasa tapas / मानसं तपः	austerity of the mind
prasāda / प्रसाद	serenity
saumyatva / सौम्यत्व	gentleness
mauna / मौन	silence
bhāva-saṁśuddhi / भावसंशुद्धि	purity of heart
dātavyam / दातव्यम्	'it ought to be given'
avibhaktam / अविभक्तम्	undivided

COMMENTARY

AUSTERITY OF THE MIND

Verse 17.16 has five parts: serenity (prasāda), gentleness (saumyatva), silence (mauna), self-control (ātma-vinigraha) and bhāva-saṁśuddhi, purity of heart. The last is the Gita's own word for what Swami Vivekananda calls chitta-shuddhi and our course calls lowering the noise floor. Body, speech, mind: the clearing works from outside inwards (our reading).

SATTVIC GIVING

Verse 17.20 gives three marks: it is given because it ought to be given, to one who cannot repay, and in the right place and time to a worthy person. There is no expectation of return and no display. The seva of slide 23 is the same: giving that keeps no accounts.

SATTVIC KNOWLEDGE

Verse 18.20 is the Gita's definition of sattvic knowledge: seeing one imperishable Being in all beings, undivided in the divided. The next verses give the other two kinds: rajasic knowledge sees many separate beings, and tamasic knowledge clings to one part as if it were the whole. This is the heart of tonight: the light within is one light in all, so to see the Divine in another is to know truly.

SLIDE 19

Sattva in daily life: acting, the doer, the happiness (18.23, 18.26, 18.37)



ON THE SLIDE

Acting (18.23): action done as duty, without attachment, without love or hatred, by one who does not seek its fruit. The doer (18.26): free from attachment, not boastful, firm and enthusiastic, unmoved by success or failure. The happiness (18.37): at first like poison, at the end like nectar, born of the serenity of a mind turned to the Self.

The slide asks: which of the eight is already strongest in me, and which is the one I least expected to find on this list?

Bhagavad Gita 18.23

नियतं सङ्गरहितमरागद्वेषतः कृतम् ।

अफलप्रेप्सुना कर्म यत्तत्सात्त्विकमुच्यते ॥ १८-२३॥

niyataṁ saṅgarahitamarāgadveṣataḥ kṛtam |
aphalaprepsunā karma yattatsāttvikamucyate | | 18-23| |

Acting: action done as duty, without attachment, without love or hatred, by one who does not seek its fruit. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 18.26

मुक्तसङ्गोऽनहंवादी धृत्युत्साहसमन्वितः ।

सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योर्निर्विकारः कर्ता सात्त्विक उच्यते ॥ १८-२६॥

muktasaṅgo'nahaṁvādī dhṛtyutsāhasamanvitaḥ |
siddhyasiddhyornirvikāraḥ kartā sāttvika ucyate | | 18-26| |

The doer: free from attachment, not boastful, firm and enthusiastic, unmoved by success or failure. (our paraphrase)

Bhagavad Gita 18.37

यत्तदग्रे विषमिव परिणामेऽमृतोपमम् ।

तत्सुखं सात्त्विकं प्रोक्तमात्मबुद्धिप्रसादजम् ॥ १८-३७॥

yattadagre viṣamiva pariṇāme'mṛtopamam |
tatsukhaṁ sāttvikaṁ proktamātmabuddhiprasādajam || 18-37||

The happiness: at first like poison, at the end like nectar, born of the serenity of a mind turned to the Self. (our paraphrase)

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

niyata / **नियत**	done as duty, regulated
saṅga / **सङ्ग**	attachment
dhṛti / **धृति**	firmness, fortitude
utsāha / **उत्साह**	enthusiasm
ātma-buddhi-prasāda / **आत्मबुद्धिप्रसाद**	the serenity of a mind turned to the Self

COMMENTARY

FOUR MARKS OF SATTVIC ACTION

Done as duty, without attachment, without love or hatred, and without craving for the result. This is Karma-yoga in the Gita's own words, which Swami Vivekananda says purifies the mind (slide 21). Results still matter, but our peace is no longer held hostage to them.

FIVE MARKS OF THE DOER

Free from attachment, not boastful (does not keep saying 'I'), firm, enthusiastic, and unmoved by success or failure. Firmness and enthusiasm together: calm without dullness. Compare 12.13 on slide 16: no idea of 'mine' and egoism.

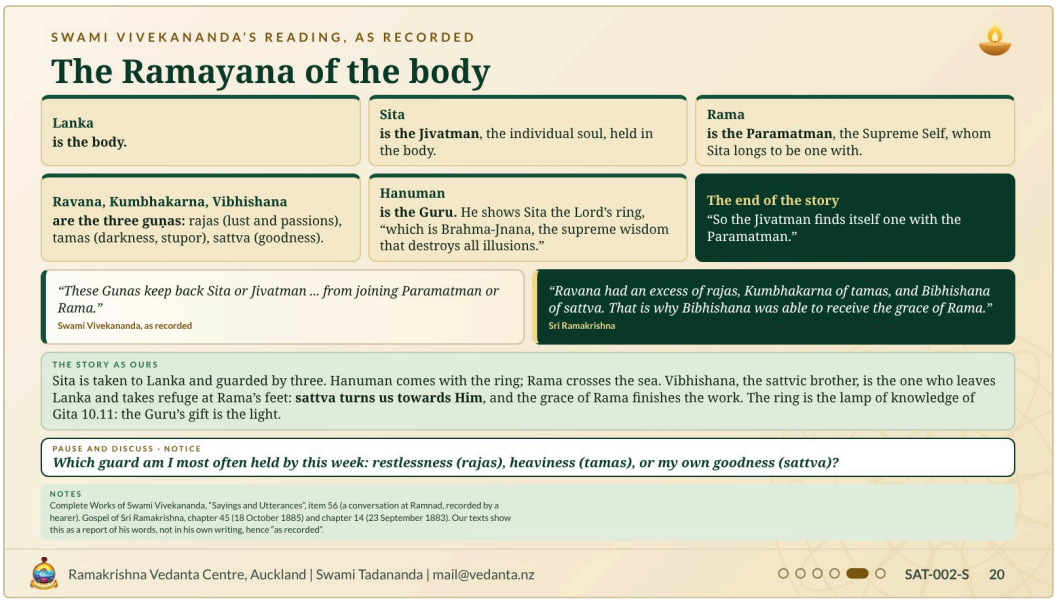
THE TEST OF HAPPINESS

Sattvic happiness begins like poison because it asks effort and discipline, and ends like nectar. The verses that follow describe the reverse, the happiness of the senses: nectar at first, poison at last. It is born of the serenity of a mind turned to the Self. This is the 'inner joy' mark, manaḥ-prasāda, on our Lamp card.

REFLECT

Which of the eight is already strongest in me, and which is the one I least expected to find on this list?

SLIDE 20 The Ramayana of the body



ON THE SLIDE

Swami Vivekananda's reading of the Ramayana, as recorded: Lanka is the body. Sita is the Jīvātman, the individual soul, held in the body. Rama is the Paramātman, the Supreme Self, whom Sita longs to be one with. Rāvaṇa, Kumbhakarṇa and Vibhīṣaṇa are the three guṇas: rajas (lust and passions), tamas (darkness, stupor) and sattva (goodness). Hanumān is the Guru, who shows Sita the Lord's ring, 'which is Brahma-Jnana, the supreme wisdom that destroys all illusions'. So the Jīvātman finds itself one with the Paramātman.

Sri Ramakrishna: 'Ravana had an excess of rajas, Kumbhakarna of tamas, and Bibhishana of sattva. That is why Bibhishana was able to receive the grace of Rama.'

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Jīvātman / जीवात्मन्	the individual soul
Paramātman / परमात्मन्	the Supreme Self
Brahma-jñāna / ब्रह्मज्ञान	knowledge of Brahman, the supreme wisdom

COMMENTARY

A STORY READ INWARDLY

The Ramayana is a story of exile, abduction, a long search and a return. Swami Vivekananda, as recorded, reads it as the story of the soul. The body is Lanka, where the soul is held. The three guṇas are the three guards or brothers. The Guru brings the ring, which is wisdom, and the soul is reunited with the Supreme.

THE STORY AS OURS

Sita is taken to Lanka and guarded by three. Hanuman comes with the ring; Rama crosses the sea. Vibhishana, the sattvic brother, is the one who leaves Lanka and takes refuge at Rama's feet: sattva turns us towards Him, and the grace of Rama finishes the work. The ring is the lamp of knowledge of Gita 10.11: the Guru's gift is the light. This retelling is our reading, built on the two sources above.

A CAUTION

Even Vibhishana, the sattvic one, needed grace. Sattva is the window through which the light comes, and it is not the light. We should not be proud of our own goodness: the question on this slide asks which guard holds us most, including our own goodness.

GOING DEEPER

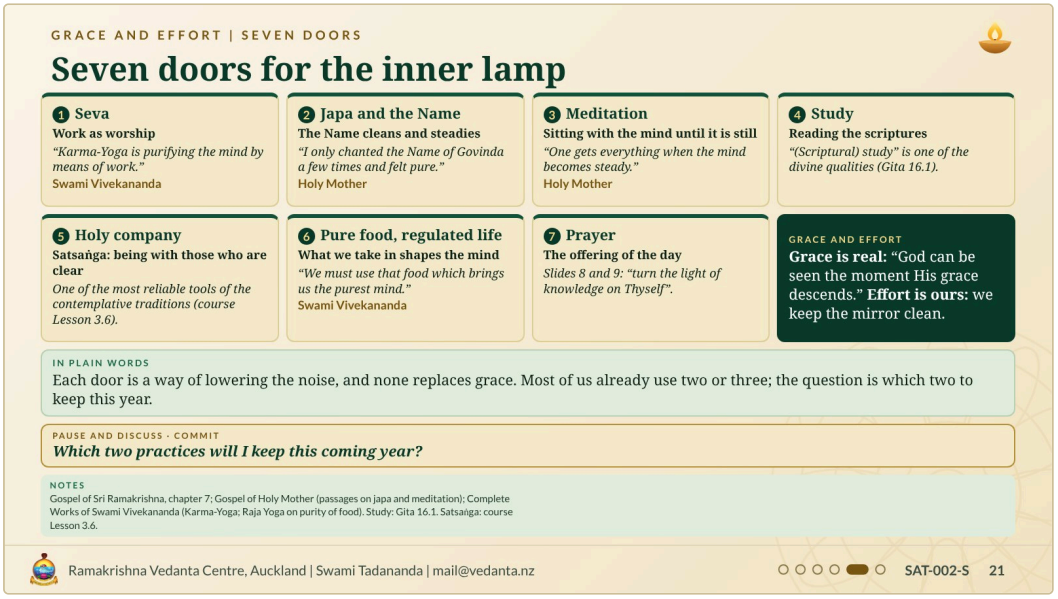
ON THE SOURCES

Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda, 'Sayings and Utterances', item 56, a conversation at Ramnad recorded by a hearer. Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, chapter 45 (18 October 1885) and chapter 14 (23 September 1883). Our texts show this as a report of Swami Vivekananda's words, not in his own writing, hence 'as recorded'.

REFLECT

Which guard am I most often held by this week: restlessness (rajas), heaviness (tamas), or my own goodness (sattva)?

SLIDE 21 Seven doors for the inner lamp



ON THE SLIDE

Seven ways to lower the noise and tend the lamp, each with a quotation or a reference: seva, work as worship ('Karma-Yoga is purifying the mind by means of work', Swami Vivekananda); japa and the Name ('I only chanted the Name of Govinda a few times and felt pure', Holy Mother); meditation ('One gets everything when the mind becomes steady', Holy Mother); study (scriptural study is one of the divine qualities, Gita 16.1); holy company, satsaṅga (course Lesson 3.6); pure food and a regulated life ('We must use that food which brings us the purest mind', Swami Vivekananda); and prayer, the offering of the day (slides 8 and 9).

Below: grace and effort. Grace is real; effort is ours.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

seva / सेवा	service offered as worship
japa / जप	repetition of a sacred name or mantra
satsaṅga / सत्सङ्ग	holy company
sādhana / साधना	spiritual practice

COMMENTARY

SEVEN DOORS, NOT SEVEN RULES

The seven are ways to lower the noise, and none replaces grace. Most of us already use two or three. The question is which two we will keep this year. A practice kept is worth more than a long list admired.

ONE DOOR AT A TIME

Seva purifies the mind through work offered to the Divine. Japa cleans and steadies. Meditation sits with the mind until it is still. Study feeds it with good words. Holy company brings us near those who are clear. Pure food and a regulated life stop us from muddying the mind daily. Prayer offers the day. They support one another, so improving one tends to help the rest.

GRACE AND EFFORT

'God can be seen the moment His grace descends.' Effort is ours: we keep the mirror clean. These are not in conflict. We do not make the sun rise, and we do open the shutters.

A PRACTICAL WAY TO CHOOSE

Look at the past week. Which of the seven did you actually do? Keep those, and add one that would make the biggest difference. Write the two on the Lamp card.

GOING DEEPER

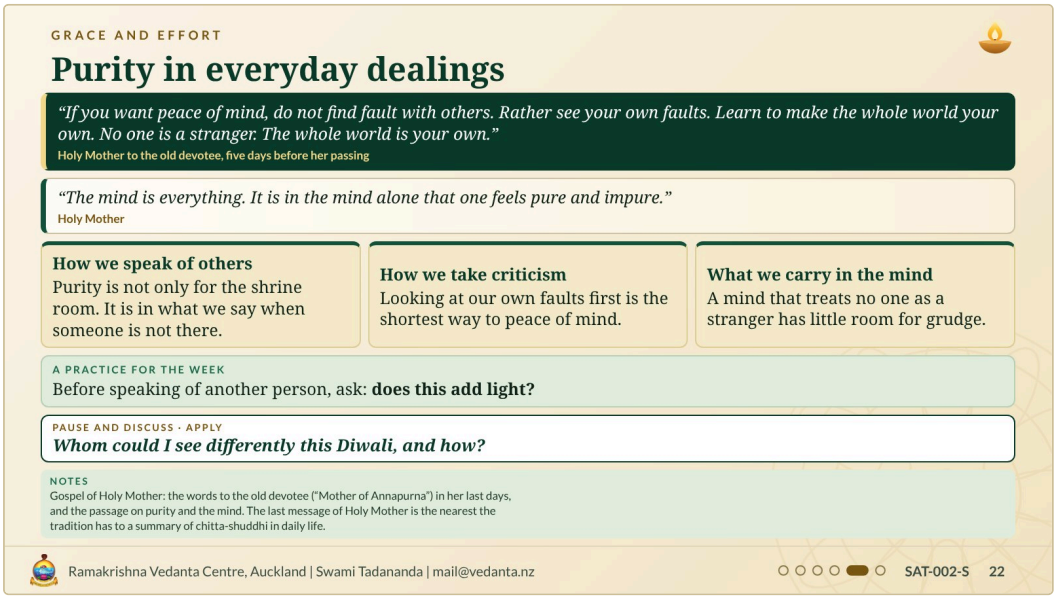
ON THE SOURCES

Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, chapter 7; the Gospel of Holy Mother (passages on japa and meditation); Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda (Karma-Yoga; Raja Yoga on purity of food). Study: Gita 16.1. Satsaṅga: course Lesson 3.6.

REFLECT

Which two practices will I keep this coming year?

SLIDE 22 Purity in everyday dealings



ON THE SLIDE

Holy Mother, to the old devotee, five days before her passing: 'If you want peace of mind, do not find fault with others. Rather see your own faults. Learn to make the whole world your own. No one is a stranger. The

whole world is your own.' And: 'The mind is everything. It is in the mind alone that one feels pure and impure.'

Three places where purity shows: how we speak of others, how we take criticism, and what we carry in the mind. A practice for the week: before speaking of another person, ask, does this add light?

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

śuddhi / शुद्धि	purity, cleansing
nirmala / निर्मल	stainless, pure

COMMENTARY

PURITY IS NOT ONLY FOR THE SHRINE ROOM

It is in what we say when someone is not there. It is in how we hear a criticism. It is in the grudges we carry or put down. Holy Mother's words are very simple, which is why they are hard.

THE SHORTEST WAY TO PEACE OF MIND

Looking at our own faults first, and not finding fault with others, is the shortest way to peace of mind. Notice that she does not say faults do not exist. She says our peace depends on where we point our attention. A mind that treats no one as a stranger has little room for a grudge.

A WEEK'S PRACTICE

Before speaking of another person, ask: does this add light? This is the practical form of the Gita's tests of speech in 17.15. It does not forbid honest concern, only the kind of speech that leaves a darker room behind it.

GOING DEEPER

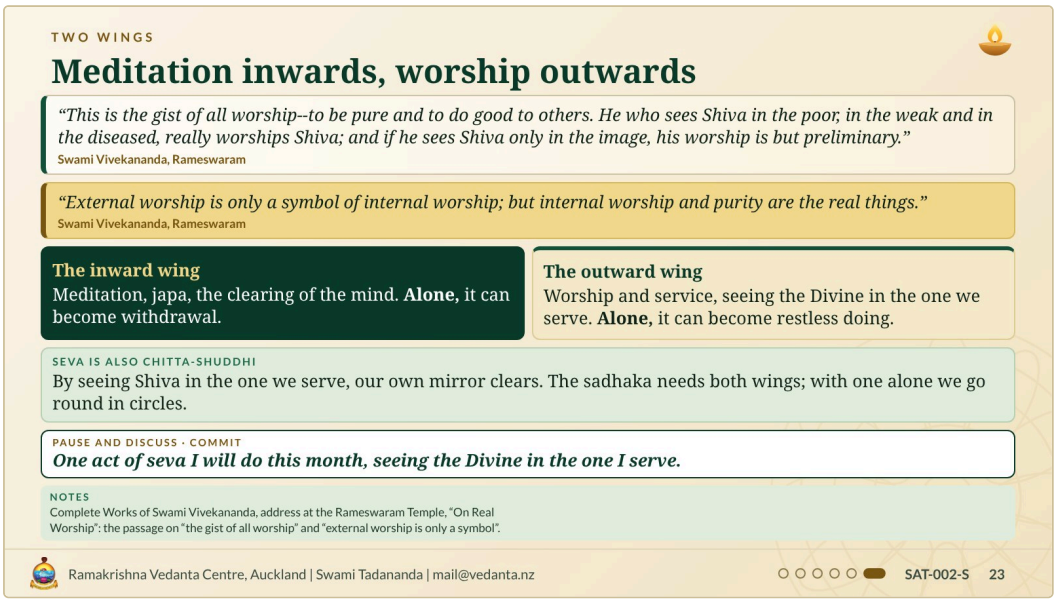
ON THE SOURCE

Gospel of Holy Mother: the words to the old devotee ('Mother of Annapurna') in her last days, and the passage on purity and the mind. Her last message is the nearest the tradition has to a summary of chitta-shuddhi in daily life.

REFLECT

Whom could I see differently this Diwali, and how?

SLIDE 23 Two wings: meditation inwards, worship outwards



ON THE SLIDE

Swami Vivekananda at Rameswaram: 'This is the gist of all worship--to be pure and to do good to others. He who sees Shiva in the poor, in the weak and in the diseased, really worships Shiva; and if he sees Shiva only in the image, his worship is but preliminary.' And: 'External worship is only a symbol of internal worship; but internal worship and purity are the real things.'

The inward wing is meditation, japa and the clearing of the mind; alone, it can become withdrawal. The outward wing is worship and service, seeing the Divine in the one we serve; alone, it can become restless doing. Seva is also chitta-shuddhi.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

seva / सेवा	service offered as worship
Śiva / शिव	here, the Divine seen in the poor, the weak and the sick

COMMENTARY

WHY TWO WINGS

A bird with one wing goes round in circles. Meditation alone can slide into withdrawal, where peace depends on being left alone. Service alone can slide into restless doing, where we are busy but not clear. Together they correct each other: meditation steadies the doer and service keeps meditation honest.

SEVA CLEARS THE MIRROR

By seeing Shiva in the one we serve, our own mirror clears. Service is not only a duty to others; it removes what is dull in us: self-concern, comparison, small irritation. This links back to the Gita's karma-yogis working 'for the purification of the heart' (5.11).

ONE ACT THIS MONTH

The slide asks for one concrete act of seva this month, seeing the Divine in the one served. Small is fine: a visit, a meal cooked for someone, regular help at the Centre. The test is that it is done, and done as worship.

GOING DEEPER

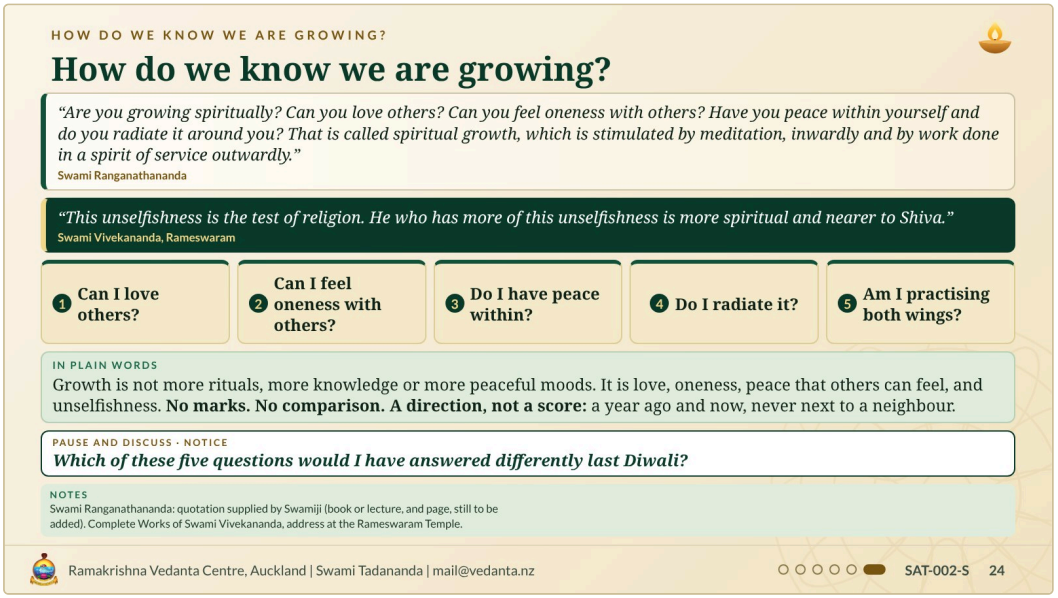
ON THE SOURCE

Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda, address at the Rameswaram Temple, 'On Real Worship', the passage on 'the gist of all worship' and 'external worship is only a symbol'.

REFLECT

One act of seva I will do this month, seeing the Divine in the one I serve.

SLIDE 24 How do we know we are growing?



ON THE SLIDE

Swami Ranganathananda: 'Are you growing spiritually? Can you love others? Can you feel oneness with others? Have you peace within yourself and do you radiate it around you? That is called spiritual growth, which is stimulated by meditation, inwardly and by work done in a spirit of service outwardly.' Swami Vivekananda: 'This unselfishness is the test of religion. He who has more of this unselfishness is more spiritual and nearer to Shiva.'

Five gentle questions: Can I love others? Can I feel oneness with others? Do I have peace within? Do I radiate it? Am I practising both wings?

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

sādhaka / साधक	one who practises; a spiritual aspirant

COMMENTARY

WHAT GROWTH IS NOT

Growth is not more rituals, more knowledge or more peaceful moods. It is love, oneness, peace that others can feel, and unselfishness. A person can attend many satsangs and not grow, and a person with little formal practice can grow a great deal. The questions look at the fruit, not the effort.

FIVE QUESTIONS, GENTLY

The questions are not a test. No marks and no comparison. They are a direction, to be asked of ourselves a year ago and now, never next to a neighbour. A small honest 'a little more than last year' is a good answer.

THE TWO WINGS AGAIN

The fifth question returns to the two wings: meditation inwards and service outwards. If only one is being used, the growth is likely to be lopsided.

GOING DEEPER

ON THE SOURCES

Swami Ranganathananda: the quotation was supplied by Swami Tadananda (the book or lecture and page are still to be added). Swami Vivekananda: Complete Works, address at the Rameswaram Temple.

REFLECT

Which of these five questions would I have answered differently last Diwali?

SLIDE 25 Looking back, gently: the year behind



ON THE SLIDE

Four minutes of silence, written, on the first half of the Lamp card. Three questions: where did I feel the light this year, a moment, a person, a practice? What clouded it, a habit, a mood, a worry, a word, named without blaming anyone, yourself included? What am I grateful for, small things included? Then a look at the six marks: truthfulness, purity, inner joy, kindness, compassion, unselfishness. Which have grown a little, which have dimmed? Write it as a note, not a score.

The slide also says: if reflecting brings up something heavy, speak to a trusted friend, teacher or health professional.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

kṛtajñatā / कृतज्ञता	gratitude

COMMENTARY

WHY LOOK BACK AT ALL

Diwali is the end of one year and the beginning of the next in many traditions, and a gentle review is an old custom of closing the accounts. Here it is not an accounting of sins. It is a way of noticing where the light was, so that we can go towards it.

NAMING WITHOUT BLAME

The second question asks what clouded the light, and asks us to name it without blaming anyone, ourselves included. Blame closes the mind again. Naming opens it. 'A worry' or 'a word' is already a good answer.

GRATITUDE

The third question is a counterweight. A year seen only through its problems is untrue. A meal, a kindness or a quiet hour counts, and writing them down is itself a purifying act.

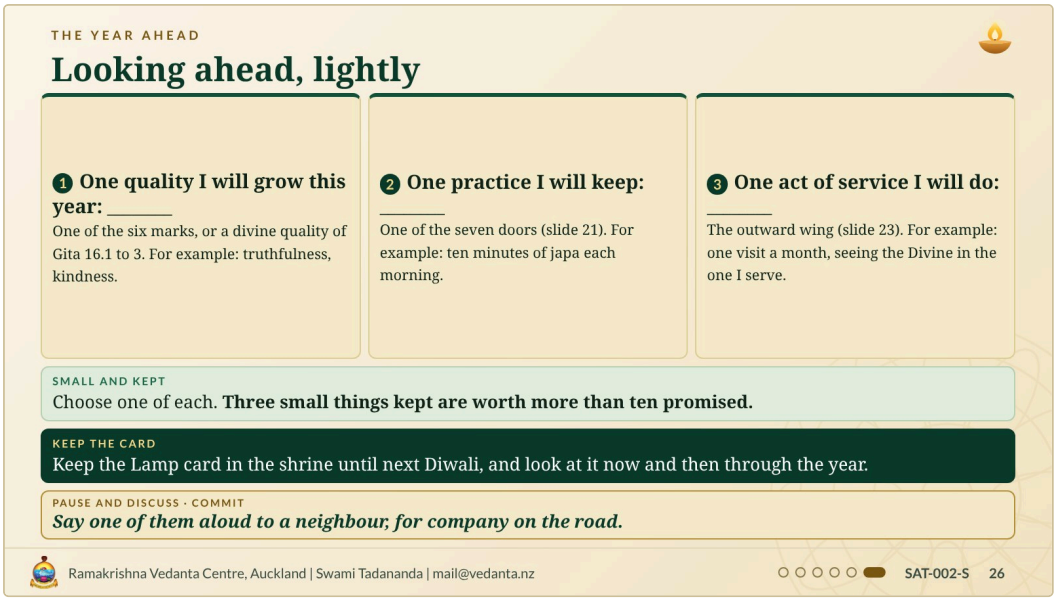
A CAREFUL WORD

These questions are for reflection and not a test. If remembering the year brings up something heavy, that is a reason to talk with someone you trust, not a reason to push on alone.

REFLECT

A moment this year when I felt the light.

SLIDE 26 Looking ahead, lightly: the year ahead



ON THE SLIDE

Three lines on the second half of the Lamp card: one quality I will grow this year (one of the six marks, or a divine quality of Gita 16.1 to 3, for example truthfulness or kindness); one practice I will keep (one of the seven doors, slide 21, for example ten minutes of japa each morning); one act of service I will do (the outward wing, slide 23, for example one visit a month, seeing the Divine in the one I serve).

Small and kept: three small things kept are worth more than ten promised. Keep the Lamp card in the shrine until next Diwali. Say one of them aloud to a neighbour, for company on the road.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

saṅkalpa / सङ्कल्प	a resolve, a determined intention

COMMENTARY

ONE OF EACH

One quality, one practice, one act of service: the three correspond to the three things this satsang has been about. The quality is the direction of the clear mind, the practice is the way we tend the lamp, and the service is the outward wing.

SMALL AND KEPT

A resolution made on one evening is only as good as its smallest daily form. 'Ten minutes of japa each morning' is better than 'become more spiritual'. 'One visit a month' is better than 'serve more'. Choose

something you can still do on a poor day.

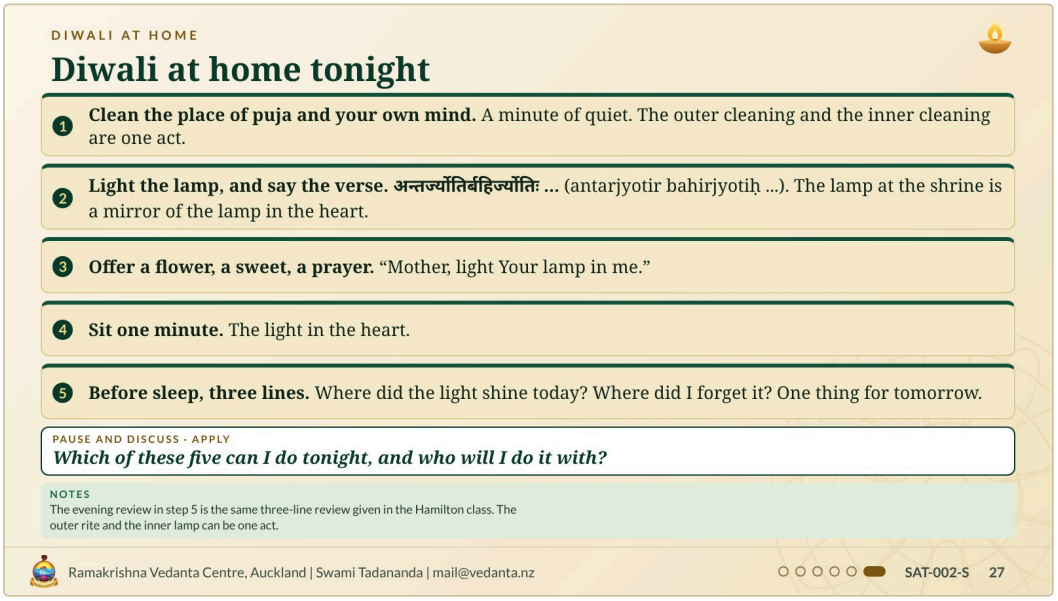
COMPANY ON THE ROAD

Saying one of the three aloud to a neighbour is an old and practical idea: a resolve that someone else has heard is harder to drop quietly. It need not be a promise to them; it can simply be said.

REFLECT

Say one of them aloud to a neighbour, for company on the road.

SLIDE 27 Diwali at home tonight



ON THE SLIDE

Five steps for the evening. 1. Clean the place of puja and your own mind: a minute of quiet; the outer cleaning and the inner cleaning are one act. 2. Light the lamp, and say the verse (antarjyotir bahirjyotiḥ ...); the lamp at the shrine is a mirror of the lamp in the heart. 3. Offer a flower, a sweet, a prayer: 'Mother, light Your lamp in me.' 4. Sit one minute: the light in the heart. 5. Before sleep, three lines: where did the light shine today, where did I forget it, one thing for tomorrow.

Brahma Jñānāvalī Mālā 21, attributed to Adi Śaṅkarācārya

अन्तर्ज्योतिर्बहिर्ज्योतिः प्रत्यग्ज्योतिः परात्परः ।

ज्योतिर्ज्योतिः स्वयंज्योतिरात्मज्योतिः शिवोऽस्म्यहम् ॥

antarjyotir bahirjyotiḥ pratyagjyotiḥ parātparaḥ |
jyotirjyotiḥ svayaṃjyotir ātmajyotiḥ śivo'smyaham ||

The light within, the light without, the light in every being, higher than the highest; the light of all lights, self-luminous, the light of the Self: I am Shiva, the auspicious. (A free English rendering for satsang.)

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

pūjā / पूजा	worship, the ritual offering
dīpa / दीप	a lamp

COMMENTARY

THE OUTER AND THE INNER AS ONE ACT

Nothing here replaces the family customs of the evening. It simply puts an inner meaning on them. Tidying the puja place is also tidying the mind. Lighting the lamp is also lighting the lamp in the heart. The rite and the lamp can be one act.

THE EVENING REVIEW

Step 5 is the same three-line review given in the Hamilton class: where the light shone today, where I forgot it, and one thing for tomorrow. It takes two minutes and, kept up, is one of the most effective ways of keeping the mirror clean.

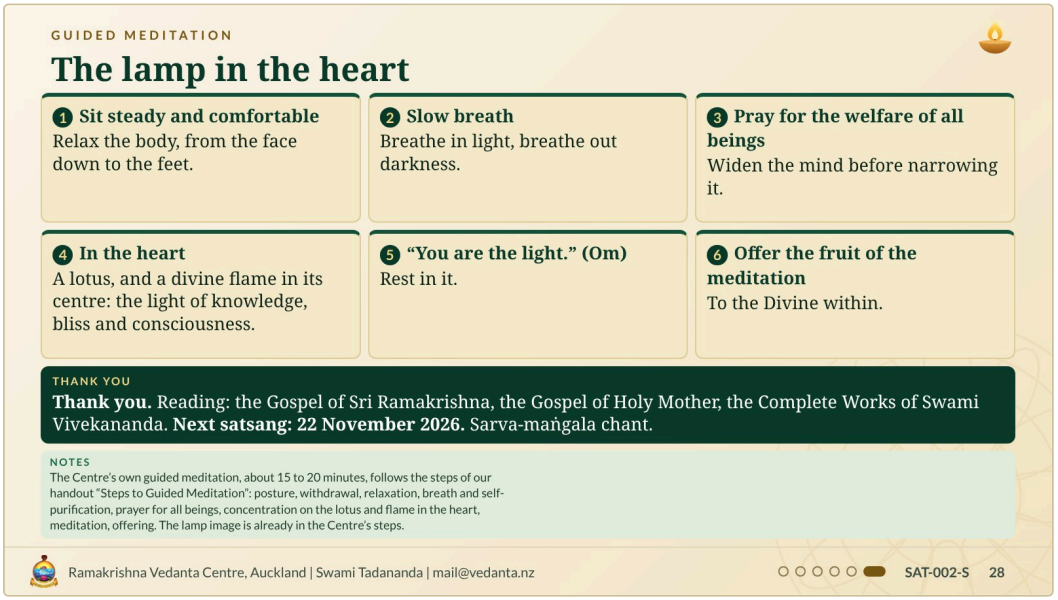
WHO WILL YOU DO IT WITH

The slide asks which of the five can be done tonight and with whom. Doing even one with a family member or a friend turns it from a private duty into a shared evening.

REFLECT

Which of these five can I do tonight, and who will I do it with?

SLIDE 28 Guided meditation: the lamp in the heart



ON THE SLIDE

Six steps for the guided meditation, about 15 to 20 minutes: sit steady and comfortable and relax the body from the face down to the feet; slow breath, breathe in light, breathe out darkness; pray for the welfare of all beings, widening the mind before narrowing it; in the heart, a lotus and a divine flame in its centre, the light of knowledge, bliss and consciousness; 'You are the light' (Om), rest in it; offer the fruit of the meditation to the Divine within.

The slide closes with thanks, the reading list, the date of the next satsang (22 November 2026) and the Sarva-maṅgala chant.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

dhyāna / ध्यान	meditation, unbroken flow of attention
Om / ॐ	the sacred syllable
Sarva-maṅgala	the chant for the welfare of all

COMMENTARY

HOW THE STEPS WORK

The meditation follows the steps of the Centre's handout 'Steps to Guided Meditation': posture, withdrawal, relaxation, breath and self-purification, prayer for all beings, concentration on the lotus and flame in the heart, meditation, and offering. The lamp image is already in the Centre's steps, so it joins the satsang's theme naturally.

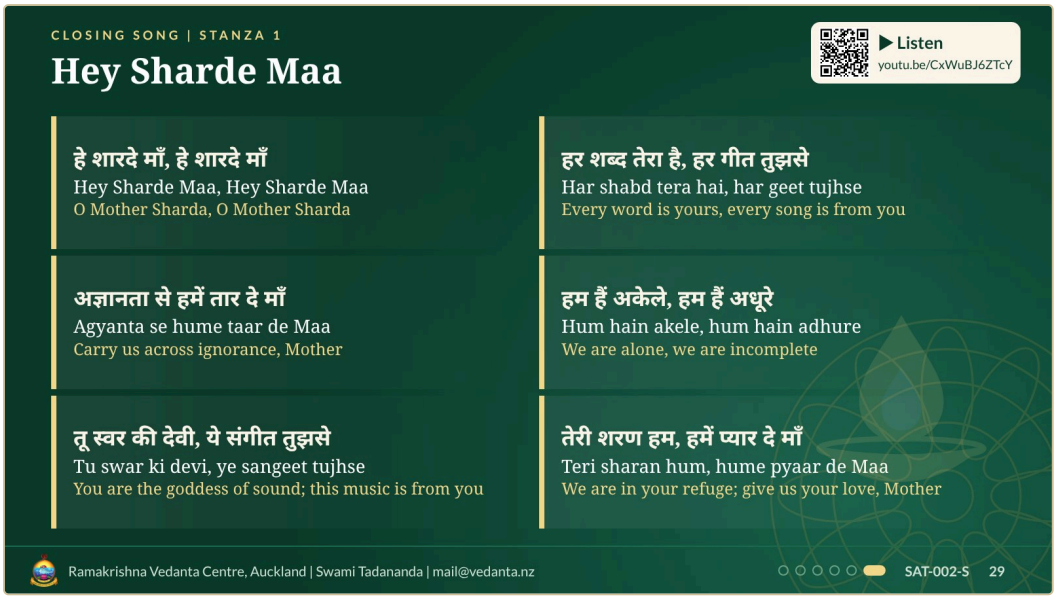
WIDEN BEFORE NARROWING

Step 3 comes before step 4 for a reason. Praying for the welfare of all beings first widens the mind, and then concentration on the heart does not become a tight, self-concerned effort.

TO PRACTISE ALONE

Sit for ten minutes. Work through the steps slowly; spend longest on steps 4 and 5. End with the offering, and then sit a minute before moving. If the mind wanders, return gently to the flame. The aim is steadiness, not an experience.

SLIDE 29 Closing song: Hey Sharde Maa (stanza 1)



ON THE SLIDE

The first stanza in Devanagari, roman and English: Hey Sharde Maa, O Mother Sharda; carry us across ignorance, Mother. You are the goddess of sound, this music is from You; every word is Yours, every song is from You. We are alone, we are incomplete; we are in Your refuge, give us Your love, Mother.

A Listen link and QR code at the foot take you to the recording on YouTube.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

Śāradā / शारदा	a name of Sarasvatī, goddess of learning and sound; also the name of Holy Mother
ajñānatā / अज्ञानता	ignorance
śaraṇa / शरण	refuge

COMMENTARY

WHY THIS SONG ENDS THE MORNING

The morning began with a prayer to the Divine Mother as Kāli and closes with a prayer to the Mother as Śāradā. The first line of this song asks to be carried across ignorance, which is the very darkness of Gita 10.11 and the dust on the mirror. The last lines say we are alone and incomplete and take refuge. That is a good attitude to carry out of the door.

A NOTE

Śāradā is a name of Sarasvatī, goddess of learning and sound, and it is also the name of Holy Mother, Sri Sarada Devi. The song as written speaks to the goddess of learning; singing it in our satsang to Holy Mother as well is our reading. The words are as given in the recording, with the English meaning of each line.

ABOUT THE RECORDING

The recording is a commercial recording and is linked on YouTube, not hosted on our site. Use the Listen link on the slide.

SLIDE 30 Closing song: Hey Sharde Maa (stanzas 2 and 3)



ON THE SLIDE

Stanza 2: the sages understood it, the wise have known it; the language of the Vedas, the voice of the Puranas; let us too understand, let us too know; give us the right to knowledge, Mother. Stanza 3: You are white in colour, seated on the lotus; the veena in Your hands, a crown on Your head; wiping the darkness from our minds, give us a world of light, Mother.

WORD BY WORD AND KEY TERMS

vidyā / विद्या	knowledge, learning
vīṇā / वीणा	the stringed instrument held by Sarasvatī
ujālā / उजाला	light

COMMENTARY

THE LAST LINE

The song ends with a prayer that fits the whole morning: wipe the darkness from our minds and give us a world of light. The same prayer is the one we began with in the Gita: He, residing in the heart, destroys the darkness by the lamp of knowledge. We have asked for a world of light, and we are asked to carry a small lamp ourselves.

WHAT TO CARRY HOME

Three small things: the Lamp card filled in, the evening rite for tonight, and the sitting each day. If one of them is kept until next Diwali, this morning has done its work.

A1 The Lamp card

The Lamp card is a small card to be written on during the satsang and kept in the shrine until next Diwali. Its two halves match slides 25 and 26. Print this page, or copy the lines into a notebook.

THE SIX MARKS (A DIRECTION, NOT A SCORE)

Truthfulness	satyam (16.2)
Purity	sattva-saṁśuddhi, purity of mind (16.1)
Inner joy	manaḥ-prasāda, serenity of the mind (17.16)
Kindness	dayā bhūteṣu, kindness to creatures (16.2)
Compassion	friendly and compassionate (12.13)
Unselfishness	renunciation; no idea of 'mine' and egoism (16.2, 12.13)

FIRST HALF: THE YEAR BEHIND

- Where did I feel the light this year? (a moment, a person, a practice)
- What clouded it? (a habit, a mood, a worry, a word; without blame)
- What am I grateful for?

SECOND HALF: THE YEAR AHEAD

- One quality I will grow this year:
- One practice I will keep (one of the seven doors, slide 21):
- One act of service I will do (the outward wing, slide 23):

A2 The evening at home and the guided meditation

DIWALI AT HOME TONIGHT (SLIDE 27)

- Clean the place of puja and your own mind: a minute of quiet.
- Light the lamp and say the verse *antarjyotir bahirjyotiḥ …* (slide 7).
- Offer a flower, a sweet, a prayer: "Mother, light Your lamp in me."
- Sit one minute: the light in the heart.
- Before sleep, three lines: where did the light shine today, where did I forget it, one thing for tomorrow.

GUIDED MEDITATION: THE LAMP IN THE HEART (SLIDE 28)

- Sit steady and comfortable; relax the body from the face down to the feet.

- Slow breath: breathe in light, breathe out darkness.
- Pray for the welfare of all beings.
- In the heart: a lotus, and a divine flame in its centre, the light of knowledge, bliss and consciousness.
- "You are the light." (Om) Rest in it.
- Offer the fruit of the meditation to the Divine within.

For ten minutes alone, go through the steps slowly and stay longest with steps 4 and 5. If the mind wanders, return to the flame.

A3 Songs, sources and how we quote

THE SONGS

Ke jane Kali kemon (slides 4 to 6), by Ramprasad, in roman Bengali with the line-by-line meanings supplied by Swami Tadananda, and the English of the Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna. Recording: *youtu.be/MFMXWTyWpsE*.

Hey Sharde Maa (slides 29 and 30), a Hindi prayer to Mother Śāradā. The recording is on YouTube: *youtu.be/CxWuBJ6ZTcY*. The recording is a commercial one, so we link to it and do not host it.

SOURCES

- The Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna, tr. Swami Nikhilananda (chapters cited on each slide).
- The Gospel of Holy Mother.
- The Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda (Karma-Yoga, Raja Yoga, the Rameswaram address, Sayings and Utterances).
- The Bhagavad Gita, as given in Swami Tadananda's Gita Study for Sunday Classes (verses and translation as written there).
- Brahma Jñānāvalī Mālā, verse 21 (attributed to Adi Śaṅkarācārya), on slide 7.
- Swami Ranganathananda: quotation supplied by Swami Tadananda (slide 24).
- The course The Mind in the Light of Modern and Spiritual Sciences, Lessons 3.4 and 3.6 (slide 12).

HOW WE QUOTE

We quote only from the sources above, in their own words, and give the place. Anything that is our own reading is called our reading. The English of Gita 17.8 to 18.37 is our paraphrase of the verses, built from the word meanings in the Gita Study.

A4 Questions to keep, and next steps

FIVE QUESTIONS TO KEEP THROUGH THE YEAR

- What is the dust on my own mirror just now, and what clears it?
- Which of the six marks could I show a little more of this week?
- Which of the three guṇas, calm, restless or heavy, led my last week, and what fed it?
- Which two of the seven doors will I keep this coming year?
- Whom could I see differently this Diwali, and how?

THIS SATSANG AND THE NEXT

This satsang: Sunday 8 November 2026, 11:00 am to 1:00 pm, Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre, 27 Arawa Street, New Lynn, and on Zoom. To receive the Zoom link, register at www.vedanta.nz/event-list.

Next satsang: Sunday 22 November 2026.

A note on care. These questions are for reflection and not for scoring. If remembering the year brings up something heavy, please speak to a trusted friend, a teacher or a health professional.